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## PLANS CHARGESHEET FILING BY SEPTEMBER 25

# SIT finds 105 instances of Ram Temple donation theft, SC told

### OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 21

The Special Investigation Team (SIT) examining missing donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya has identified 105 instances of theft, the Supreme Court was told on Monday. Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said a chargesheet will be filed by September 25, the day the 90-day period from the first arrest ends and the accused could become eligible for default bail.

The count comes from a status report the SIT submitted in a sealed cover on September 16. Investigators studied hundreds of hours of CCTV footage, along with witness statements, digital receipts and bank deposit records, to trace how money was taken before it reached bank lockers. The report also explains that receipts for valuables are generated through software and the items are kept in a State Bank of India locker.

The figure is higher than the 70 instances listed in the interim report of the first SIT, headed by Vijay Vishwas Pant, which the



state government formed on June 13. The second team was constituted on July 26 after the court stepped in. Its members are Inspector General of Police Kiran S, Deputy Inspector General Somen Barma, Senior Superintendent of Police Gaurav Grover and Additional Superintendent of Police Ritesh Kumar Singh.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana reviewed the report and expressed satisfaction with the probe. It declined a request from the petitioners for a copy,

saying it did not want to take the matter out of the sessions judge's hands. The court said it would pass further orders if more investigation was needed.

Mehta told the bench that the 90 days would end on September 25. The chargesheet must be filed by then, he said, "otherwise, they (the accused) will get default bail." Under Section 187 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, which replaced Section 167(2) of the CrPC, an accused becomes entitled to statutory bail if the chargesheet is not filed within the stipu-

lated period.

The case began on June 7, when Samajwadi Party leader Tej Narayan 'Pawan' Pandey alleged that Rs 5 crore to Rs 7.5 crore was siphoned off from temple offerings. On June 26, eight employees who handled and counted donations were arrested: Anukalp Mishra, Lavkush Mishra, Ram Shankar Yadav 'Tinnu', Manish Yadav, Subhash Srivastava, Avinash Shukla, Rama Shankar Mishra and Karunesh Pandey. They face charges including criminal breach of trust, cheating, theft and criminal conspiracy under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, as well as Section 13(1)(a) of the Prevention of Corruption Act. Police recovered Rs 79,85,493 from them, found in bathrooms, haystacks and cow dung cakes.

### KEY POINTS

- » Earlier SIT had recorded 70 theft instances
- » Investigators examined hundreds of hours of CCTV footage
- » Digital receipts and bank records were also analysed
- » SIT reconstructed alleged diversion of temple donations
- » Valuables are receipted through software and stored securely

## Court revives case over Sonia Gandhi's pre-citizenship voter roll entry

### MPOST BUREAU

New Delhi, September 21

A Delhi sessions court on Monday ordered a fresh hearing on a complaint seeking registration of an FIR over the alleged inclusion of Congress leader Sonia Gandhi's name in the electoral roll before she acquired Indian citizenship in 1983.

Special Judge Vishal Gogne set aside an order of the Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate (ACJM), which had declined to direct a probe into the allegations. The revision plea was filed by advocate Vikas Tripathi, vice-president of the Central Delhi Court Bar Association at Rouse Avenue courts. **CONTINUED ON P4**

## FSSAI flags Nestle infant food products, files three cases

### AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 21

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has initiated legal action against Nestle India over alleged violations involving three infant nutrition products, while the company said its products and labels comply with applicable regulations.

The action concerns NAN Excella Pro Stage 1, Lactogen Pro 1 and a follow-up formula. The regulator said it reviewed the products and promotional material available on e-commerce platforms before seeking clarifications from Nestle India. **CONTINUED ON P4**

## OPPOSITION SLAMS GOVT

# Outrage in Bihar after minors harassed in Jamui; 3 arrested as video goes viral

### MPOST BUREAU

Jamui (Bihar), September 21

Three people have been arrested and a Special Investigation Team (SIT) formed after a video purportedly showing a minor boy and girl being confronted and harassed by a group in Bihar's Jamui district went viral on social media, prompting intervention by women's rights bodies and criticism from opposition parties. Police said the incident occurred on the evening of September 19, while the National Commission for Women (NCW) has sought a time-bound investigation and



### SIT FORMED, POLICE IDENTIFY SEVEN PERPETRATORS

an action-taken report from the Bihar Director General of Police.

Jamui Superintendent of Police Bishwajeet Dayal said the incident took place around 7 pm within the jurisdiction

of Jamui police station. According to the police, the two minors, who are friends and attend the same coaching institute, had gone for coaching and later visited the area to take photographs.

The video, which was circulated widely online, appears to show several people surrounding the two teenagers at night. The girl is seen being confronted by a group, while the boy appears to be separated from her during the incident. At one point, a man with his face covered appears to move towards the girl and lift her, prompting her to

scream and resist. The boy also appears to intervene as the confrontation escalates before the two eventually get away.

Police said the video came to their notice on Monday and helped them identify the victims. Dayal said no complaint had been made by the boy or girl until Sunday, but investigators traced them using the registration number of a vehicle visible in the footage.

"Based on the video, we identified the victims and recorded their statements," Dayal said, adding that an SIT headed by **CONTINUED ON P4**

### OUR CORRESPONDENT

Kolkata, September 21

The Calcutta High Court has extended its interim protection, allowing the Mamata Banerjee-led faction of the All India Trinamool Congress to operate three bank accounts frozen by the West Bengal Police, holding that the Election Commission's interim arrangement over the party's name and symbol did not amount to a final determination of the factional dispute.

Justice Saugata Bhattacharya passed the order while hearing a petition by the Mamata-AITC faction challenging the freezing

## INTERIM RELIEF EXTENDED

# HC allows Mamata faction to operate 3 frozen bank A/Cs

### THE CASE

» The state had argued that the faction could no longer claim control over accounts held in the AITC's name after the ECI, ahead of the bypolls, recognised the two groups separately as Mamata-AITC and Democratic-TMC

» The order had not determined which faction constituted the "real TMC" and had not authorised the Democratic-TMC faction to operate or deal with the accounts



of the accounts. The state had argued that the faction could no longer claim control over accounts held in the AITC's name after the ECI, ahead of the bypolls, recognised the two groups

separately as Mamata-AITC and Democratic-TMC.

Petitioners' counsel submitted that the substantive question of which faction was entitled to represent the party **CONTINUED ON P4**

# India adds 4 medals as gold wait continues

Suchika makes history with India's first mixed martial arts Asiad medal



Suchika Tariyal takes a victory lap with the tricolour after securing a bronze medal in the women's traditional 60kg mixed martial arts event at the Asian Games in Nagoya, Japan, on Monday

### MPOST BUREAU

Nagoya/New Delhi, September 21

India's wait for a gold medal continued at the Asian Games on Monday, with three shooting medals taking the country's tally to six, while Suchika Tariyal secured a historic bronze in mixed martial arts after a heartbreaking semifinal exit.

India now has four silver and two bronze medals. Shooting accounted for three of Monday's medals, with Himanshu Dhillon winning silver and Rudranksh Patil taking bronze in the men's 10m air rifle individual event. The duo, along with 18-year-old Parth Mane, also claimed silver in the team competition.

China again dominated the event, with Sheng Lihao, Changhong Zhang and Sihan Ma combining for 1899.0 points to win gold and set a new world record. Their score bettered the previous mark of 1898.4 set in Cairo last year.

### ASIAN GAMES

- » Shooting contributed three medals on Monday
- » Himanshu Dhillon won individual silver in 10m air rifle
- » Rudranksh Patil secured individual bronze in 10m air rifle
- » India won team silver in men's 10m air rifle
- » Parth Mane joined Dhillon and Patil for team silver

The team silver brought attention to Mane, a former junior world champion, and 21-year-old Dhillon, who is still adapting to the senior circuit.

In MMA, 36-year-old Suchika became India's first Asian Games medalist in the sport by taking bronze in the traditional women's 60kg category. **CONTINUED ON P4**

## ONGC strikes gas in Mahanadi deepwater well

Eyes faster monetisation near Odisha coast

### OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 21

State-run Oil and Natural Gas Corp (ONGC) has discovered gas in a deepwater well off the Odisha coast, a find that could be brought into production relatively quickly if further appraisal establishes commercial viability.

The discovery was made on September 18 at the MN-DW18-1-H-D well in the Mahanadi Offshore Basin, about 43 km from Konark, under ONGC's Samudra Manthan deepwater exploration campaign.

The well, the first drilled by ONGC in the Mahanadi Basin under the campaign, encour-

tered gas between depths of 1,441 and 1,452 metres. It was drilled to a target depth of 1,623 metres after being spudded on July 25 using the drillship Platinum Explorer.

ONGC said the well has been flowing gas for three days, reporting "encouraging flow and reservoir pressure".

The company said the discovery remains subject to further appraisal and commercial evaluation. The next stages will include assessing the reservoir, estimating recoverable resources and determining whether the find can support commercial development. Its location close to the Odisha coast **CONTINUED ON P4**









# Delhi CM launches PM Surya Ghar portal for rooftop solar registration

Smaller homes encouraged to install solar systems of up to 2 kW

AIMAN FATIMA  
New Delhi, September 21

The Delhi government on Monday opened registration for its rooftop solar programme, offering a combined Centre and Delhi government subsidy of up to Rs 1.56 lakh and targeting 2.30 lakh households in the first phase. Chief Minister Rekha Gupta and Power Minister Ashish Sood launched the ‘Delhi PM Surya Ghar’ portal at the Delhi Secretariat.

The portal, solar.delhi.gov.in, will allow residents to register for rooftop solar systems, access subsidy-related information, select authorised vendors and raise complaints. Applications opened on Monday and will be processed on a first-come, first-served basis.

Under the scheme, the Centre provides a subsidy of up to Rs 78,000 for systems of up to 3 kW, while the Delhi government has announced an additional subsidy of the same amount. The government said domestic consumers with average monthly consumption of up to 400 units can get rooftop systems of up to 3 kW without upfront payment under the arrangements put in place for the scheme.

Addressing the launch, Gupta said the programme



was aimed at expanding rooftop solar while reducing household electricity expenses.

“The ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ is not just about announcing schemes, but about taking facilities to people in a way that delivers a direct benefit in their daily lives,” she said.

Gupta also said the initiative would cover households with limited rooftop space. Systems of up to 2 kW are being encouraged for smaller homes, while assistance for solar installations in common areas and open spaces of group housing societies has been increased from Rs 2,000 per kW to Rs 11,000 per kW. A separate incentive has also been announced for consumers in the 0-200 unit monthly consumption category. According to the government, consumers

reducing their electricity use after installing solar panels will receive a financial incentive linked to the units saved.

The government has adopted a Utility Led Aggregation model for eligible low-income and economically weaker households, under which solar systems will be installed without upfront payment. Vendors will handle operation and maintenance for the first five years, after which maintenance will be arranged through discoms and authorised agencies.

Sood said the portal marked an expansion of the government’s approach to providing electricity benefits through rooftop generation.

“The scheme brings both free electricity and income opportunities for residents through rooftop

**UNDER THE SCHEME, THE CENTRE PROVIDES A SUBSIDY OF UP TO RS 78,000 FOR SYSTEMS OF UP TO 3 KW, WHILE THE DELHI GOVERNMENT HAS ANNOUNCED AN ADDITIONAL SUBSIDY OF THE SAME AMOUNT**

solar panels,” he said.

Sood said the government had retained the existing free electricity provision while adding rooftop generation as another benefit for eligible households.

“In the first phase, the target is to provide free rooftop solar panels to more than 2.30 lakh families,” he said, adding that Delhi could move towards becoming a “Solar Capital” through wider adoption of rooftop systems.

The minister also said consumers could use solar-generated power for nearly 25 years and potentially earn through surplus electricity generation.

The government said the portal will serve as a single platform for applications, scheme information, subsidy details, authorised vendors and complaints.

# E-bus drivers’ strike: Govt seeks Labour dept’s view on wages

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 21

Delhi Transport Minister Pankaj Singh has directed officials that the labour department be consulted on the issue of protesting DTC drivers’ salaries, a senior government official said on Monday.

For the past six days, drivers working with private companies hired by the Delhi Transport Corporation (DTC) for its electric buses have been on strike demanding a hike in daily wages with the implementation of a basic dearness allowance (DA), medical facilities and overtime payment.

“Based on the set of demands submitted by the drivers on strike, the labour department has been asked to give its opinion on the issue related to their daily wages and what the existing labour laws state in this regard,” the senior government official said.

Last week, the transport minister held a meeting with drivers and private company representatives, where the protesters raised the salary issue. “As the ongoing strike is causing discomfort to passengers, the government is trying to find a solution,” the official added.

The DTC Karamachari Ekta Union has threatened to launch a complete ‘kaam

“**ACCORDING TO THE DRIVERS AND CONDUCTORS, THEY ARE PAID RS 862 PER DAY, OF WHICH RS 60 GOES TOWARDS PF...**

band’ agitation from September 28, over non-implementation of basic DA for DTC contract employees and submitted a letter to the Chief Minister’s and the Delhi L-G Office.

“For the past two years, the file regarding basic DA of DTC employees has been pending with you; it is also been passed from the DTC Board and is with the finance department.

Our demands are -- implement the basic DA immediately, and secondly, private drivers operating DTC buses should be taken on the corporation’s payroll with immediate effect,” the letter said.

According to the drivers and conductors, they are paid Rs 862 per day, of which Rs 60 goes towards provident fund, leaving them with the remaining amount.

Private bus drivers continued their strike, citing the lack of assurances from companies over their demand for higher salaries.

# Ministers can be treated as ordinarily resident in constituency: Delhi CEO

AIMAN FATIMA  
New Delhi, September 21

The Delhi Chief Electoral Officer on Monday clarified that Cabinet ministers can be treated as ordinarily resident in the constituency where they would have otherwise been residing, even if their official duties require them to stay elsewhere, amid reports and political claims over the enrolment of ministers at addresses other than their current place of residence.

The CEO cited Section 20(4) of the Representation of the People Act, 1950, under which persons holding offices declared by the President are deemed to be ordinarily resident in the constituency where they would have been ordinarily resident but for holding such office. Cabinet ministers of the Union or a state are among the offices covered by a 1960 presidential notification.

The clarification came as the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of Delhi’s electoral rolls entered the claims and objections phase. The CEO said names of public representatives and other prominent persons earlier flagged in the electoral database were included in the draft roll so that supporting documents

could be collected during the claims and objections period.

The poll authority also reiterated that issuance of a notice does not mean deletion of an elector’s name. Notices have been generated for voters who could not be linked with the electoral roll of the last SIR or whose records showed logical discrepancies.

No name can be deleted without an opportunity of being heard and a proper speaking and appealable order, the CEO said. Electors can submit replies and documents before the concerned ERO or AERO.

The disposal of notices and claims will continue till October 29, while the final electoral roll is scheduled for publication on November 4.

Meanwhile, 92,284 Form-6 applications were received between August 31 and September 20, taking the total received since the start of the exercise to 304,684. Form-8 applications stood at 33,353 during the period, taking the cumulative figure to 294,121.

Additional AEROs deployed to expedite claims, while special camps will be held on September 27 and for marginalised groups on September 23-24.

# Delhi govt plans honorarium hike, felicitation for Anganwadi workers

New Delhi, September 21

The Delhi government is considering an increase in the honorarium of Anganwadi workers and will organise felicitation programmes across all 70 Assembly constituencies from September 23 as part of its Seva Sankalp Abhiyan, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said on Monday.

The programme, ‘Aangan Ka Milan’, will see Anganwadi workers, helpers, beneficiaries, children, pregnant and lactating women, parents and community representatives participate in constituency-level events. Around 25,000 invitations are being sent out, with nearly 500 people proposed to attend each programme.

Gupta said Anganwadi

“**A SPECIAL FELICITATION KIT WORTH RS 2,500 HAS BEEN PREPARED...**

workers form a key link between government services and children and women at the grassroots level and their contribution needed to be recognised.

The government is also considering increasing their honorarium, she said, without specifying the proposed amount or timeline for the revision.

A special felicitation kit worth Rs 2,500 has been prepared for Anganwadi workers. It will include a bag, uniform, insulated water bottle, cap, first-aid pouch and umbrella.

The kits will be presented to frontline workers during the Assembly-level programmes.

The events will also include a nutrition pledge and have been linked with the ninth National Nutrition Month 2026, being observed from September 17 to October 17 under the Centre-sponsored Saksham Anganwadi and Poshan scheme.

This year’s theme is ‘Hamari Anganwadi, Hamari Zimmedari’.

The programme seeks to promote nutrition awareness and community participation, while the proposed honorarium hike and felicitation events aim to recognise Anganwadi workers’ role and strengthen grassroots support.

# WATER RATES REVISED: NDMC Dhobi Ghats get relief on water bills

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 21

Dhobi Ghats under the New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) will now be charged water rates under the domestic category instead of commercial rates, in a move expected to reduce the water bill burden on washermen operating the designated ghats.

The decision was taken at the NDMC Council meeting, where the civic body also approved a one-time waiver of late payment surcharge (LPSC) on old outstanding water bills of Dhobi Ghats.

As part of the revised billing arrangement, the earlier 2.5-times multiplication factor applicable to the water charges has been removed. The sewerage charge will continue to be calculated at 60 per cent of the water consumption charge.

The Council has introduced the one-time LPSC waiver against the back-dropped of substantial outstanding water dues.

According to NDMC, around Rs 63.52 crore was pending towards water dues as of April 2026. The civic body said long-pending payments and disputes over bills had affected recovery of the outstanding amount.

The waiver is intended to provide relief from the surcharge while facilitating recovery of the principal amount pending against consumers.

Delhi PWD Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said the revised charges and waiver would ease the bur-

den of long-pending dues.

“The one-time LPSC waiver on pending water dues, along with rationalised water charges for Dhobi Ghats, will provide relief from the burden of long-pending dues and make the system more reasonable,” he said.

The minister said the decisions were aimed at improving everyday civic services in the New Delhi area.

The shift from commercial to domestic water charges is the key change for Dhobi Ghats, while removal of the 2.5-times factor further simplifies the billing structure. The revised sewerage component, however, will continue at 60 per cent of the water consumption charge.

# MCD carries out 44 demolition actions

ANAMTA FATIMA  
New Delhi, September 21

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) on Monday carried out 44 demolition actions across its 12 zones as part of a city-wide enforcement drive against unauthorised constructions, dangerous buildings and violations of the Master Plan of Delhi and building bye-laws.

The civic body also sealed 11 properties and issued five demolition orders during the day’s enforcement exercise, according to a statement issued by the MCD.

The action was undertaken as part of the Corporation’s continuing drive to check violations of building norms and address structures considered to pose risks to public safety.

Field officials have been directed to maintain vigilance across their respective jurisdictions and act against violations under the applicable regulations.

In the East Zone, major

demolition actions were carried out in Gandhi Nagar, Mandawali Fazalpur, New Ashok Nagar, Ganesh Nagar-II Extension and East Vinod Nagar. Enforcement action was also reported from Balbir Nagar and New Mustafabad in Shahdara.

In other parts of the city, action was taken in Ashok Vihar, Sawan Park Extension, Naraina, New Moti Nagar and Inderpuri, as well as Shalimar Bagh and Tarun Enclave, among other locations.

The MCD said it had also undertaken an enforcement exercise on Sunday, during which four properties were demolished and three were sealed for violations of the MPD and building bye-laws.

The MCD said unauthorised construction and building violations would invite action, with enforcement continuing across the city as officials intensify monitoring of construction activity and compliance with building norms.

# RITHALA DEPOT EXPANSION ALSO PLANNED

# Delhi to get 150 more e-buses

OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 21

Delhi will add 150 electric buses to its public transport fleet next month as the Transport Department steps up work on depots and charging infrastructure to support further expansion of e-buses, Transport Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said on Monday.

Singh reviewed projects under the National Electric Bus Programme (NEBP) and PM E-Drive during a meeting with the Transport Department and said infrastructure was being developed alongside the planned bus deployment.

“Delhi government is developing Bus Depots and charging infrastructure in a coordinated manner, with every site closely monitored, so that new electric buses



can be deployed without delay,” Singh said.

Delhi currently has 5,088 electric buses operating from 40 depots. Charger installation is underway at three additional depots, while five depots with a planned capacity of 768 buses are being prepared under the NEBP.

Under PM E-Drive-I, 16 depots with capacity for 2,800 electric buses are planned. Another 16 depots, with capacity for

2,710 buses, are proposed under PM E-Drive-II, with deliveries expected in phases over the next two years. The government is also developing depots at Daurala and Jhuljhuli, with capacities of 250 and 500 buses respectively, which are expected to cater to passengers from rural areas.

To expand the available space for depots and charging stations, the Transport Department has sought land

from the DDA at five locations, Tikri Kalan Village, Jaunti Village, Mungeshpur Village, Bakkarwala and Gazipur Mandi.

It has also sought charging-station space from the DDA, MCD and DMRC, besides land from the DMRC to expand the Rithala depot. The Directorate of Panchayat has allocated land to the DTC and Transport Department for additional depot and charging infrastructure.

**DELHI CURRENTLY HAS 5,088 ELECTRIC BUSES. CHARGER INSTALLATION IS UNDERWAY AT THREE ADD’L DEPOTS, WHILE 5 DEPOTS WITH A PLANNED CAPACITY OF 768 BUSES ARE BEING PREPARED**

# L-G Sandhu: ‘Cancer treatment advances must reach patients’



SHIVANGI SHUKLA  
New Delhi, September 21

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Sunday said affordability and innovation in cancer care must go hand in hand, stressing that medical advances have little value if they remain inaccessible to patients.

Addressing the annual seminar of the Indian Cancer Society on “Bridging Innovation and Affordability in Cancer Care”, Sandhu said cancer treatment had changed significantly with improved diagnostic tools, targeted therapies, advanced surgical techniques and emerging technologies such as artificial intelligence.

Speaking in the presence of Indian Cancer Society Chairperson (Delhi) Jyotsna Govil, Padma Shri Geeta Chandran and other dignitaries, Sandhu said medical progress should be measured not only by what is possible in hospitals and laboratories, but also by who can access it. A cancer diagnosis, he said, brings emotional stress, uncertainty and a significant financial burden for patients and their families.

Quoting PM Narendra Modi’s call for healthcare to be “accessible, available and affordable to all”, Sandhu said affordability could not be separated from innovation.

He identified early detection as one of the

most effective ways to make cancer care more affordable and called for greater screening and awareness, particularly for breast, cervical and oral cancers.

He also stressed the need for better awareness of warning signs and referral systems to help patients enter the healthcare system at an earlier stage.

Sandhu said Delhi’s leading medical institutions provide a strong foundation, but stronger links were needed between communities, primary healthcare, diagnostic services and specialised hospitals to ensure expertise reaches all parts of the Capital.

He said India had an opportunity to develop healthcare solutions that are advanced, affordable and suited to its needs, with universities, hospitals, start-ups, researchers and medical technology companies working on diagnostics, imaging, telemedicine and AI-assisted healthcare. Sandhu highlighted Cancer Sahyog’s 35-year support for patients through counselling, guidance and financial assistance, noting many volunteers were survivors or caregivers.

He said cancer care discussions should cover prevention, early detection, diagnosis, treatment, financial protection and emotional support for people in Delhi and across India.



Shami-Jayant meeting triggers speculation over cricketer's political debut

BISWAJEET BANERJEE  
Lucknow, September 21

The meeting between India cricketer Mohammed Shami and Rashtriya Lok Dal (RLD) president Jayant Chaudhary in Delhi has triggered fresh speculation about the fast bowler entering politics from Amroha.

Chaudhary shared a photograph of his meeting with Shami on Facebook and described meeting the cricketer as a pleasant experience.

The photograph has since fuelled discussions in political circles in Amroha and the wider Moradabad region about Shami's possible political entry.

Shami, who hails from Sahaspur Alinagar in Amroha, has been at the centre of speculation on social media over the past few days.

There has also been talk that either Shami or a member of his family could enter electoral politics.

The meeting with the RLD chief on Sunday has added to the speculation. Neither Shami's family nor RLD leaders have disclosed the purpose of the meeting or indicated whether it was linked to politics.

RLD Amroha district president Sachin Chaudhary said he was not aware of the purpose of Shami's meeting with the party's national president.

Shami has also been away from international cricket for nearly 17 months.

His last international appearance was in the Champions Trophy final against New Zealand on March 9, 2025.

He was not selected for India's tours of England and Sri Lanka.

IF FIRST IS QUASHED FOR NOT FURNISHING GROUNDS

# Supreme Court mandates Magistrates' approval for re-arrest

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 21

In a significant judgment, the Supreme Court on Monday held that an investigating agency must approach a magistrate for re-arresting a person if he/she is released by the court in the same case for not being provided grounds of arrest or being in detention for more than 24 hours.

The top court said that Articles 22(1) and 22(2) of the Constitution, which say that no person can be arrested without being provided grounds of arrest and every person arrested/detained shall be produced before the nearest magistrate within a period of 24 hours, respectively, cannot be tinkered with.

It added that what is sought to be highlighted is that once there is a breach of Article 22(1), the power to rearrest the accused must not be left to the discretion of the same authority which had violated the said provision of the Constitution, and it must have the judicial imprimatur.

A bench of Justices Ujjal Bhuyan and A S Chandurkar said that the Constitution or a constitutional provision cannot be interpreted in a vacuum, and that interpretation of the Constitution cannot be left to imponderables in the form of ifs and buts.

"The Constitution is based on certain basic principles, much above the statutory threshold. Therefore, violation of the Constitution or a constitutional provision cannot be countenanced. It has to be dealt with strictly. It is not



## KEY POINTS

- » The top court said that Articles 22(1) and 22(2) of the Constitution, which say that no person can be arrested without being provided grounds of arrest and every person arrested/detained shall be produced before the nearest magistrate within a period of 24 hours, respectively, cannot be tinkered with
- » 'The Constitution is based on certain basic principles, much above the statutory threshold'

dependent on the nature or gravity of the offence, encompassing within its sweep all offences. It cannot be interpreted in a restrictive manner," the bench said.

Justice Bhuyan, who penned the verdict on behalf of the bench, said that when a certain procedure is prescribed by the Constitution or the laws for depriving a citizen of his personal liberty, it is the duty of the court to ensure that such a procedure is rigorously observed, howsoever strange this might sound to some ears.

"If upon release of such an accused, the investigat-

ing agency is still of the opinion that for furthering the course of investigation it is necessary to have custodial interrogation of the accused, then, as directed in Paragraph 65 of Mihir Rajesh Shah (2025 verdict), the investigating agency has to file an application before the concerned magistrate for custody, mentioning therein the reasons for rearrest of the accused and the necessity for the same," the bench said.

The top court strengthened the mechanism, which was held in the Mihir Rajesh Shah case, and directed that appli-

cation for rearrest be brought to the knowledge of superior officers and department proceedings be initiated against erring police officers.

Justice Bhuyan said the court is bound by the ratio laid down in the Mihir Rajesh Shah case and endorses the course of action declared thereof and would like to further stress upon and strengthen the safeguards introduced by way of the said judgment when it comes to rearrest of an accused who is released from custody for breach of Article 22(1).

The bench said the application for rearrest of the person should also contain the explanation for non-supply of the grounds of arrest to the accused at the first instance and can only be moved after furnishing the grounds of arrest to the accused.

"To rule out any foul play or collusion, such an application must have the endorsement of the immediate superior authority.

This is because the immediate superior authority should know that the concerned officer has committed an unbecoming act of violating a constitutional provision for which necessary remedial steps will have to be taken.

"On receipt of such application with the endorsement, the concerned magistrate shall decide the same expeditiously and as directed in the Mihir Rajesh Shah case, preferably within a week of its submission, by adhering to the principles of natural justice," the top court said.

The bench said only when the magistrate is satisfied that for bona fide reasons the grounds of arrest could not be furnished to the arrestee at the first instance but furnished subsequent to his release and on further satisfaction that the accused needs to be re-arrested, he may pass an order permitting the investigating agency to rearrest.

"On the administrative side, the superior authority, when presented with the application seeking his endorsement for custody of the accused who has been released for violation of Article 22(1), shall hand over the investigation of the case to another officer, further directing a department inquiry for such a serious lapse.

"If the enquiry culminates in an adverse finding against the erring police officer(s), it would entail department action with entry in the service book of such officer(s)," the top court said.

## 'More than 89 lakh citizens pledge support for Ayurveda'

More than 9,700 activities have been reported across 30 states and Union Territories, ministry said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 21

As the country prepares to observe the 11th Ayurveda Day on Wednesday, nationwide public participation has gathered momentum under the theme "Ayurveda for a Healthier Tomorrow", the Ayush ministry has said.

More than 9,700 activities have been reported across 30 states and Union Territories, with over 3.6 lakh participants registered through the official Ayurveda Day website. Nearly 89.3 lakh citizens have also pledged their support for Ayurveda through the Ayurveda Day 2026 microsite, the ministry said in a statement.

The 11th Ayurveda Day 2026 has also witnessed participation beyond India, with activities reported from 10 countries and territories and involving more than 1,900 participants, the statement said.

The participating countries and territories include the British Indian Ocean Territory, the United Kingdom, Afghanistan, Bulgaria, Spain, Algeria, Australia, Denmark, Iceland and the United States of America, it said.

The international participation reflects the growing outreach of Ayurveda Day and the involvement of communities, institutions and organisations beyond India in activities centred on Ayurveda awareness, wellness and public engagement, the statement said.

The Ayurveda Day 2026 microsite, available at ayurvedaday.org.in, serves

A WIDE RANGE OF ACTIVITIES IS BEING ORGANISED TO PROMOTE AWARENESS ABOUT AYURVEDA AND ENCOURAGE COMMUNITY PARTICIPATION

as a digital platform for citizen participation, registration and reporting of activities being organised as part of the nationwide celebrations.

States including Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh have recorded substantial participation, reflecting the extensive engagement of states and UTs in the nationwide observance, it said.

A wide range of activities is being organised to promote awareness about Ayurveda and encourage community participation.

Ayurveda awareness programmes; information, education and communication (IEC) activities; public outreach programmes, and Ayurveda health and wellness camps are among the prominent activities being reported.

Other activities include medicinal plant plantation and conservation drives, Ayurveda awareness programmes in schools and colleges, youth engagement initiatives, campaigns promoting Ayurveda Ahara and healthy dietary practices, citizen pledge campaigns and Ayurveda quizzes, the statement said.

From page 1

## Google

Google's move follows a similar decision by Meta last week after weeks of friction with the Indian government. Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg also apologised last month over the spread of child sexual abuse material on the company's platforms.

India is the largest market by users for both Google's YouTube and Meta's Facebook, making the reporting arrangements particularly significant for the companies.

The scale of the issue is reflected in NCMEC's CyberTipline, which received more than 21.3 million reports worldwide of suspected child sexual exploitation in 2025. Technology and law enforcement authorities in the US, European Union and elsewhere have also pushed platforms to improve the speed of detection and reporting, although the US non-profit remains a key international clearing house for such reports.

## IIT Bombay

informed students of the removal by email. The institute withdrew its earlier claim that Wakode was caught cheating but faced no disciplinary action, calling it "inappropriate" to describe the events before an investigation had established them.

Student groups want Doolla suspended as a professor, not just moved from the post. Protesters said Wakode faced pressure and threats of academic suspension, and that Kedare told them late Sunday he would resign. The institute says he has not.

On Monday evening, faculty members marched on campus in support of Doolla. The Faculty Forum said he followed

"Senate-approved exam procedure" when he reported the phone use on September 18, and pointed to his work on student welfare initiatives. It described media reports about him as "false and misleading".

"He was our only son," said Wakode's father, Ravindra Wakode, who alleges caste-based harassment. "I want justice." His maternal grandmother, Shyamalata Tayade, sought a probe into the administration and hostel environment. A student from the next room said academic pressure is heavy but he "never witnessed casteism on campus".

Alumnus Pranav Jeevan alleged that students have been fined up to Rs 1.5 lakh for staging a play, and that the campus lacks caste sensitisation, mental health support and an empowered SC/ST Cell. Police detained Youth Congress workers outside the gate, and about 50 personnel were deployed. The NCP (SP) said student suicides outnumber farmer suicides. Mumbai Police Crime Branch is investigating.

## Jamui

Sub-Divisional Police Officer Deepti Monali had been constituted. Police said around seven people had been identified from the video and raids were underway to arrest the remaining suspects.

The three arrested accused have not been named by the victims in the FIR, police said. The case has been registered under the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act and relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS). Police have also begun steps to remove the video from social media platforms.

Dayal said the two minors were friends but declined to provide further details, citing the need to protect sensitive information. The authenticity of the video could not be inde-

pendently verified.

The NCW has taken suo motu cognisance of the case, describing the incident in terms of alleged public molestation, assault, forcible detention and harassment. NCW Chairperson Vijaya Rahatkar wrote to the Bihar DGP directing the immediate registration of an FIR, identification and arrest of all accused based on the video, and a "time-bound and impartial investigation".

The commission has also sought security, legal assistance and psychological counselling for the victims and asked authorities to take legal steps to prevent further circulation of the video. Rahatkar has sought a detailed Action Taken Report from the Bihar DGP within seven days.

Bihar State Women's Commission Chairperson Apsara Mishra said the commission had sought a detailed report from the Jamui district administration. She said the Jamui district magistrate informed her that the incident occurred near the district's border with neighbouring Lakhisarai and that the accused had been identified.

The case also triggered a political exchange. Congress leader and Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi described the incident as "deeply disturbing" and called for those identified in the video to face prosecution under POCSO. The Aam Aadmi Party shared the video on X and questioned the BJP-led state government over the safety and dignity of women.

Former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee described the incident as "gut-wrenching" and criticised what she called "moral policing", saying people should not be allowed to decide who deserves dignity or freedom.

The Bihar government and BJP rejected the broader political criticism. Union Panchayati

Raj and Fisheries Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh said law and order in Bihar was "totally secure" and that an individual incident should not be used to assess the entire state's law-and-order situation. He said police take action when such incidents occur.

BJP spokesman Neeraj Kumar Sharma said the Bihar Police deserved credit for starting the investigation promptly, even before the victims had approached the police. He said the police had acted proactively after the video came to light.

## Mamata faction

remained pending before the ECI. He also pointed out that the High Court's earlier order in the matter had been challenged before the Supreme Court.

The High Court noted that its previous arrangement allowed the three accounts to be used only for specified purposes and subject to approval by a Special Officer. The order had not determined which faction constituted the "real TMC" and had not authorised the Democratic TMC faction to operate or deal with the accounts.

Referring to the ECI's order, the court said the poll panel itself had described the arrangement as an interim measure meant for the ensuing by-elections, pending a final decision.

The court consequently continued the interim arrangement until January 29, 2027, or until further orders.

## ONGC strikes

could help speed up monetisation if the discovery proves viable, ONGC said. The find could also potentially be developed along with other discoveries in the area using shared facilities.

Such an approach may be supported by the Petroleum and Natural Gas Rules,

2025, which allow deepwater resources in the region to be developed through shared infrastructure.

The discovery comes as ONGC expands exploration in India's frontier offshore areas, where deepwater projects can require substantial investment in appraisal and infrastructure before production begins. It also forms part of efforts to raise domestic hydrocarbon output and reduce dependence on imports.

## India adds

However, she missed out on a place in the final after her semifinal against Singapore's Hui Hoon Teo ended in a draw.

Suchika weighed 700 grams more than Teo during the morning weigh-in. Under the technical rules, the lighter competitor advances when a bout ends level.

The result left Suchika in tears despite securing a historic medal. The athlete from Killoi village in Haryana's Rohtak district is a 2024 world champion in jiu-jitsu and had represented India in judo at the 2022 Commonwealth Games and kurash at the 2022 Asian Games.

"This is more than my life. I will never forget that I came to Japan and got a medal for my country. I can now happily die," she told PTI after regaining her composure.

There were also strong results in other disciplines. India's women's hockey team thrashed Indonesia 17-1, while the men's badminton team defeated Bangladesh 3-0 to reach the quarterfinals. Lakshya Sen, K Srikanth and Ayush Shetty won their singles matches.

Sumit Kundu advanced with a comfortable win in the 70kg boxing category. India's women's and men's table tennis teams also reached the quarterfinals with identical 3-0 victories over Pakistan.

Swimming, however, remained a disappointment. Two-time Olympian Srihari Nataraj finished 10th and last in the 50m backstroke final in 25.52 seconds, slower than his 25.37-second heat timing.

In soft tennis, Aadhy Tiwari and Jay Meena lost 2-5 to the Philippines' Christy Sanosa and Sherwin Ray Nuguit in the mixed doubles round of 16.

## Sonia Gandhi

Tripathi alleged that Gandhi's name was included in the New Delhi Parliamentary Constituency electoral roll in 1980, deleted in 1982 and entered again in 1983, before she acquired citizenship on April 30 that year.

The ACJM had rejected the complaint, citing a lack of specific details supporting allegations of cheating and forgery and questioning the reliance on an uncertified photocopy of the 1980 electoral roll.

Gogne said the magisterial court had failed to examine the sequence of inclusion, deletion and re-entry of Gandhi's name. He said allegations involving fraudulent electoral entries, non-citizens being enrolled and possible use of false documents required a reasoned consideration.

"The sanctity of the electoral roll is an article of faith for every citizen in a parliamentary democracy," Gogne said.

The judge also found a legal error in the ACJM's handling of Section 175(3) of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS), which permits a magistrate to order a police investigation into a cognisable offence.

The matter was remanded for a fresh, reasoned order after hearing the complainant. It will be heard next on September 29.

## FSSAI flags

For NAN Excella Pro Stage 1, FSSAI flagged claims related to "5HMOs" and "Whey Protein".

In Lactogen Pro 1, it questioned a statement describing "Whey Protein" as easy to digest.

According to FSSAI, both products contravened Regulation 4(2) of the Food Safety and Standards (Foods for Infant Nutrition) Regulations, 2020, which restricts promotional claims or material intended to increase the saleability of infant foods. The regulator also cited Section 3 of the Infant Milk Substitutes, Feeding Bottles and Infant Foods (Regulation of Production, Supply and Distribution) Act, 1992, which prohibits advertising or promotion of such products.

Separately, laboratory testing found a Nestle follow-up formula sample to be sub-standard for Biotin. A referral laboratory conducted a re-analysis and also found the sample non-conforming with the Biotin requirement under the 2020 regulations.

FSSAI said it had filed "three separate adjudication cases against Nestle India in respect of the three products".

Nestle India rejected the suggestion of non-compliance. A spokesperson said the company's infant nutrition products were "fully compliant" with applicable regulations and that NAN EXCELLA PRO and LACTOGEN PRO, along with their labels, had been approved by an FSSAI expert committee.

The company said it had submitted a detailed response to the authorities, adding that the disputed label statements were factual and supported by scientific literature.

The dispute is the second major regulatory confrontation between FSSAI and Nestle India. In 2015, the regulator ordered a nationwide recall of Maggi noodles over alleged excessive lead levels and labelling concerns.

The ban was later lifted after authorised laboratory tests cleared the product.



2027 UTTAR PRADESH ELECTIONS

SP-Congress alliance: Seat sharing emerges key hurdle

MPOST BUREAU Lucknow, September 21

The Samajwadi Party and the Congress have announced that they will contest the 2027 Uttar Pradesh Assembly elections together as allies.

SP chief Akhilesh Yadav has said on several occasions that his party will contest the election in alliance with the Congress.

The Congress's top leadership also maintained that the alliance remains in place.

However, the two parties have yet to settle the details of how the 403 Assembly seats will be divided.

According to the sources, the Congress wants the seat-sharing arrangement to be finalised early so that it can identify its constituencies and candidates well ahead of the election.

The party has also indicated that it wants a larger role in deciding the seats it will contest. The Congress claims that even if it goes into an alliance with Akhilesh Yadav, it will do so on its own terms.

In July, Uttar Pradesh Congress in-charge Rajendra Pal Gautam had spoken of an arrangement based on equality and respect.

Meanwhile, the SP is clear about its preparations to contest all 403



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi speaks with Samajwadi Party president Akhilesh Yadav during an event

FILE PIC

KEY POINTS

- » Congress leader and the party's prominent Muslim face Imran Masood wants the number of seats and the names of the constituencies to be finalised by October
- » AIMIM president Asaduddin Owaisi has been showing interest to Samajwadi Party for an alliance
- » Bahujan Samaj Party chief Mayawati has already ruled out any alliance with either the Congress or the Samajwadi Party

Assembly seats if the alliance runs into a problem.

Congress leader and the party's prominent Muslim face Imran Masood wants the number of seats and the names of the constituencies to be finalised by October.

Masood affected that any delay in the alliance would cause the Congress

to lose its advantage.

Bahujan Samaj Party chief Mayawati has already ruled out any alliance with either the Congress or the Samajwadi Party.

AIMIM president Asaduddin Owaisi has been showing interest to Samajwadi Party for an alliance. Chandrashekhar Azad Ravan of the

Azad Samaj Party is also open to an alliance, but has so far refused to reveal whether his party will join one.

Till now, both the SP and Congress are continuing their organisational preparations in Uttar Pradesh leaving the issue aside that how and when the two parties will formally settle their seat-sharing arrangement.

Meanwhile, reviving a discussion dating back nearly two decades on the division of Uttar Pradesh, minister and SBSP chief Om Prakash Rajbhar said the nation's most populous state will be divided into four parts after a caste census.

Nabin's UP tour signals BJP's 2027 election campaign push

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, September 21

BJP national president Nitin Nabin's ongoing tour of Uttar Pradesh is being seen as the beginning of an intensified organisational campaign for the 2027 Assembly elections, with the party turning its focus to booth-level mobilisation in the politically crucial state.

Addressing Shakti Kendra workers in Meerut on Monday, Nabin called for strengthening every booth and expanding direct contact with voters.

He said the BJP had to prevent UP from returning to what he described as an era of fear, lawlessness and mafia influence.

'Method Of Disenfranchising Indians, Frankenstein monster': Cong slams SIR

Amid outrage over 33.13 lakh notices being issued in national capital

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 21

The Election Commission's SIR exercise is a "Method Of Disenfranchising Indians" and has turned into a "Frankenstein monster", the Congress said on Monday amid outrage over 33.13 lakh notices being issued in the national capital over "discrepancies" in details in enumeration forms.

Most notices were issued for voter details not matching with the information in the last Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls in 2002.

While Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge put out a lengthy statement on X, terming the SIR flawed, party general secretary in-charge communications Jai Ram Ramesh also spoke out.

Responding to a critical post over the name of late

MOST NOTICES WERE ISSUED FOR VOTER DETAILS NOT MATCHING WITH THE INFORMATION IN THE LAST SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION OF ELECTORAL ROLLS IN 2002

economist Bibek Debroy appearing in the list of voters being issued notices for discrepancies, Ramesh said, "Actually at work here is a Method Of Disenfranchising Indians."

Ramesh posted the words "Method Of Disenfranchising Indians" vertically so the first capital letter of every word together read -- "MODI".

In another post, he pointed out that the chief electoral officer, Delhi has

issued a press release on notices being sent to VIP electors and prominent individuals during the ongoing SIR.

However, the issue is not about influential persons who will find a way to have their names included, but the vast majority who will struggle to do so, the Congress leader said.

He said 5.43 crore Indians across 14 states and UTs have received such notices demanding additional documentation to prove their citizenship.

There is abundant evidence that deletions affect the most socially and economically marginalised groups, including slum dwellers, the poor and women, Ramesh said.

During the enumeration phase, names of over 6 crore voters were removed, he claimed.

The ECI must explain why after this, now an additional 5.4 crore voters are at risk of deletion, Ramesh asked.

"In Delhi, 54 per cent of voters have either been deleted or face risk of deletion. This is an absurdly high share that calls the whole voter roll into question. Other BJP states have still not released the list of voters at risk of deletion. This is an appalling lack of transparency and every state must release the list immediately," the Congress leader said.

"The CEO claims 'there is no existential crisis'," Ramesh said and added that unless voters provide adequate documentation to the satisfaction of the BLO/ERO, they can be struck off the final roll.

So they remain at risk of deletion, he added.

Rajasthan: BJP secures 197 civic body heads, twice as many as Congress

OUR CORRESPONDENT Jaipur, September 21

The BJP has won posts of mayor, chairperson and president in 197 of the 301 urban local bodies, more than twice the Congress tally of 94.

According to results available so far, Independents have won seven posts, while Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), CPI(M) and Rashtriya Loktantrik Party (RLP) have secured one each. Elections

for the posts were held in 273 urban local bodies on Monday after heads of 32 of the 305 bodies covered under the current schedule were elected unopposed.

The ruling party's performance is substantially stronger than its showing in the councillor elections, in which it won 4,182 of the 10,244 wards that went to the polls. Congress won 3,619 wards and Independents 2,273. Even though Independents accounted

Cong's 'Muslim League, Maoist' character exposed, alleges BJP

Slams 'buffoonery' at Rahul Gandhi's Indore event

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 21

The BJP on Monday lashed out at the Congress over former vice president Hamid Ansari's remarks citing former prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru's views on "Hindu right-wing communalism", alleging that they expose the Opposition party's "Muslim League, Maoist" character.

The ruling party also attacked Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi over his "Chhatron Ki Goonj" event in Indore, saying he had demeaned his constitutional post with "clownish caricature".

“ANSARI'S REMARKS HAVE THOROUGHLY EXPOSED THAT CONGRESS HAS BECOME MUSLIM LEAGUE MAOIST CONGRESS IN TOTALITY

Ansari, while speaking at an event commemorating late constitutional expert and author A G Noorani at the India Islamic Cultural Centre on Friday, referred to Nehru's view that "the real danger to India was not communism, but Hindu right-wing communalism" -- cited in

Noorani's 2019 book 'The RSS: A Menace to India'.

Addressing a press conference on Monday, BJP MP and national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said Ansari's remarks have "thoroughly exposed that Congress has become Muslim League Maoist Congress in totality".

He said the former vice president's comment also suggests that Nehru considered communism a threat, while the Congress has now shifted towards "ultra-left".

"Today, the Congress has gone ultra-left. It has taken a dive into communism, which Nehru considered a threat," he said.

Anti-drug fight should start from Gujarat, not Punjab: Kejriwal

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 21

Aam Aadmi Party chief Arvind Kejriwal on Monday, while responding to BJP president Nitin Nabin's remarks on the party's anti-drug campaign in Punjab, said the fight against drugs should begin from Gujarat's Mundra Port.

"The fight against drugs should not start from Punjab, but from Mundra Port," Kejriwal said in a post on X.

Nabin, in a post on X on Friday, said Prime Minister Narendra Modi had told him that the fight against drugs should begin from the soil of Punjab as the state's youth and its future were at risk.

"If you care even a tiny bit about Punjab, then stop the drugs coming from Gujarat," Kejriwal said in his post.

The Punjab Assembly elections are scheduled for February 2027.

On September 17, the BJP launched its 'Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra' from Pathankot, with Nabin flagging off the first of four statewide anti-drug yatras from Ekta Sthal.

The 13-day campaign will cover around 4,000 km across all 117 Assembly constituencies in Punjab to create awareness about drug abuse, particularly among the youth, according to BJP sources.

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, September 21

The Supreme Court on Monday ordered a re-investigation of the 2012 Sowjanya Rape-Murder case in Dharmasthala of Karnataka.

The top court also ordered that a re-investigation report should be submitted within three months.

While directing a fresh probe, the Supreme Court issued strict guidelines to ensure transparency in the investigation.

The Bench made it clear that officials from the local police, CID and CBI who were part of the earlier investigations must be kept out of the new SIT.

THE TOP COURT ALSO ORDERED THAT A RE-INVESTIGATION REPORT SHOULD BE SUBMITTED WITHIN THREE MONTHS

The case was initially investigated by the Karnataka CID and later the CBI, after which Santhosh Rao was the lone accused, and was acquitted by the CBI court in 2023.

The fresh probe into the case was welcomed by Sowjanya's mother, who has been waging a decade-long legal fight to get justice for her daughter.

The case pertains to the brutal rape and murder of Sowjanya, a 17-year-old

student while going back to home after classes, in Ujire, a small town near Dharmasthala on October 9, 2012.

The lone accused Sathosh was acquitted in June 2023, with the CBI Special Court going heavy on the shortcomings by initial investigation by the state police.

Meanwhile, Sowjanya's mother, Kusumavathy has been maintaining that the police and the investigating agencies are protecting the real culprits by moving the investigation deliberately away from the findings.

The case and its investigation had also shed light onto mass burials and multiple unsolved killings in the Kannada town of Dharmasthala.

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
I, Deepak S/o Shambhu and Kalpana R/o Plot No. 2, Nangla Part-2, Nangla Gujran, 121004, Faridabad Haryana have applied for Indian citizenship under the Citizenship Act, 1955. I currently reside at the aforementioned address and wish to obtain Indian citizenship in accordance with Indian law. If anyone has any queries or objections regarding my application for Indian citizenship, they may submit their representations within the stipulated period.  
Name: Deepak; Address: Plot No. 2, Nangla Part-2, Nangla Gujran, 121004, Faridabad Haryana; Date: 21/09/2026.

**COURT NOTICE**  
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)  
IN THE COURT OF Ms. Suman Civil Judge Junior Division, BAHADURGARH  
Balbir Vs. Dharampal CS/198/2018 CNR No. HRJRAO-000338-2018 Next Date:- 28-09-2026  
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO:  
Def. 1(i) Ashok S/o Dharampal Def. 1(iv) Rani D/o Dharampal Def. 1(v) Suman D/o Dharampal All Rs/o Village Ladrawan, Tehsil Bahadurgarh, Jhaljhar In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 28-09-2026 at 10:00 am. For details logon to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/2med=distrial notice&distrial=Jhaljhar  
Sd/- Ms. Suman Civil Judge Junior Division dated 21-09-2026 BAHADURGARH

—:— छगगस्टेट वेयरहाउसिंग कार्पोरेशन —:—  
प्रधान कार्यालय ग्राम-झाड़ा, सेक्टर-24, अटल नगर, रायपुर (छगग) क्रं / 10349 / छगवेका / निर्माण / 2026-27 / नवा रायपुर दि- 21.09.2026  
ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट द्वितीय निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना  
Main Portal : https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in/  
छगगस्टेट वेयरहाउसिंग कार्पोरेशन के प्रबंध संचालक की ओर से ऑनलाईन निविदाएं छगगशासन के लो.नि.वि. में सक्षम श्रेणी में पंजीकृत ठेकेदारों से प्रपत्र "अ" प्रतिशत दर पर निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना के अंतर्गत निगम के विभिन्न शाखा परिसरों में मरम्मत एवं अन्य आनुशांगिक कार्य हेतु ई-प्रोक्यूरमेंट सिस्टम के माध्यम से गुप क्रमांक 03 गीदम, केशलूर एवं करपावंड के गोदाम परिसर में मरम्मत एवं आनुशांगिक कार्य की गुपवार द्वितीय निविदा आमंत्रण तथा निगम के शाखा खोखरा में सी.सी.रोड़, शाखा उच्चविट्टी में सी.सी.रोड़ एवं शाखा औरदा में सी सी रोड़ निर्माण कार्य की पृथक-पृथक द्वितीय निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है। निविदा की विस्तृत जानकारी cgswc.cg.gov.in एवं https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in/ तथा अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यपालन अभियंता, छगगस्टेट वेयरहाउसिंग कार्पोरेशन नवा रायपुर अटल नगर के फोन नं. 0771-2272990, 992 पर संपर्क की जा सकती है।  
सामवद 49121/3 कार्यपालन अभियंता

| HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                         |                                    |                                |                |               |                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------|---------------|---------------------|
| The Executive Engineer Ghumarwin Division HP-PWD, Ghumarwin on behalf of Governor of HP invites the Percentage Rate bids, in electronic tendering system, from the eligible class of contractors registered with HPPWD for the works as detailed in the table.                                                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                         |                                    |                                |                |               |                     |
| Sr. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Name of work                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Estimated Cost (in lacs)                                                                | Starting Date for down-loading Bid | Deadline for submission of Bid | Eligible Class | Earnest money | Cost of Tender form |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Construction of way side amenities (WSA) at Ahur Phase-2 Dist-Bilaspur (HP) (SH- Heritage Haven & Retail Block /C landscape Component- ing, Furniture work, Electrical work, Plumbing work and Fire fighting work etc.). | Rs. 679337454/- Civil Component- Rs. 498771613/- and Electric Component- Rs.180565841/- | 24-09-2026                         | 01-10-2026                     | A              | Rs.7800000/-  | Rs.80000/-          |
| The Technical Bid of the above tenders will be open on dated 02/10/2026 at 10:00AM. The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website www.hpnders.gov.in.<br>Executive Engineer Ghumarwin, Division, HP-PWD, Ghumarwin On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh<br>Ro.No 3560/2026-2027 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |                                                                                         |                                    |                                |                |               |                     |

**DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS SAMBA**  
" HUE & CRY NOTICE."

As intimated by SHO PS Samba vide his office letter No. 2589/5-1/PSS Dated 18.09.2026, that the accused person namely BaghHussain @ Bagu S/O Ali Hussain R/O Rakhbaration, Tehsil Vijaypur, District Samba is involved in case FIR No. 72/2026 U/S 109/132/115(2)/118(2)/191(2)/191(3) BNS of Police Station Samba, the accused is evading his arrest since 30.03.2026. The photograph of the said accused person is required to be published/telecast in print/electronic media for his identification/arrest. As such, a Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused person is being published/telecast on Print/Electronic media for information of Police Establishments so that they could be identified and any information related to them may be communicated on following contacts:-  
1. PCR Samba:- 01923-246333, 9541649001  
2. SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in  
3. SHO PS Samba:- 9419105294

The description roll along with photograph of accused person is as under:-  

|                         |                                               |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| Name:                   | BaghHussain @ Bagu                            |
| Parentage:              | S/O Ali Hussain                               |
| R/O :                   | Rakhbaration, Tehsil Vijaypur, District Samba |
| Age:                    | 36 yrs                                        |
| Colour                  | Brownish                                      |
| Height                  | 5 Feet 10 Inch                                |
| Distinguishing Features | Beard as visible in photograph                |

No. CB/Look/2026/ Dated:- 09.2026

Sd/-  
Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

**कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय**  
**पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, चतरा**  
eercdchatra-jhr@nic.in

**(शुद्धि पत्र)**  
एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि पथ निर्माण विभाग, पथ प्रमंडल, चतरा द्वारा दिनांक 24.09.2026 को प्राप्त की जाने वाली निविदा, जो **PR No.- PR-388741(Road)26-27(D)** द्वारा ई0 प्रोक्वोरमेंट नोटिस सं0 – 05/2026-27 (1<sup>st</sup>Call) आमंत्रित की गई है। ई0 प्रोक्वोरमेंट नोटिस सं0 – 05/2026-27 (1<sup>st</sup>Call) को अपरिहार्य कारणों से निरस्त किया जाता है।  
कार्यपालक अभियंता, प0नि0ड0, पथ प्रमंडल, चतरा  
**PR 390279 Road(26-27)#D**

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, CHATRA**

**e-Procurement Tender Cancele Notice**  
**Letter no- 630 Date 21/09/2026**  
एतद् द्वारा सूचित किया जाता है कि PR 379462 Minor Irrigation (26-27)#D Tender Reference No. WRD/MID/CHATRA/F2-02/2026-27 Date- 11.05.2026 Renovation of Barki Tal Ahar, Block-Mayurhand, District-Chatra को अपरिहार्य कारणों से उक्त निविदा को पुनर्निविदा करने हेतु रद्द की जाती है।  
Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Chatra  
**PR 390236 Minor Irrigation (26-27) D**



INDIGENOUSLY DESIGNED BY MAHARASHTRA-BASED FIRM

# Powering India's battle tank fleet: MoD signs Rs 586-crore APU deal

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

New Delhi, September 21

The Ministry of Defence, on Monday, agreed to a contract worth Rs 586 crore with Maharashtra-based Accurate Industrial Controls Private Limited for the acquisition of indigenously designed Auxiliary Power Units (APUs) for the Indian Army's T-72 and T-90 main battle tanks. The agreement was signed in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh in New Delhi.

As per defence officials, this move will improve the readiness of India's mechanised army units. They also argued that the acquisition is not only important for the quantity of the APU being acquired but also for the use of an indigenous industry-developed system in sustaining two of the Army's key armoured platforms.

An Auxiliary Power Unit, in essence, is a portable power generation unit fitted onto a military vehicle. With respect to a tank, it means that this unit serves as a power-generating source that allows the functioning of various units within the tank without keeping the engine always on.

It becomes especially relevant in relation to a modern armoured vehicle because it uses electricity to run such critical systems as the fire control system, firing system, gun stabilisation, and various additional devices. An APU allows gen-



Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh and others during the signing of the APU procurement deal

## HIGHLIGHTS

- » The agreement was signed in the presence of Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh in New Delhi
- » As per defence officials, this move will improve the readiness of India's mechanised army units

erating the electricity independently of the tank's engine and provides it to the units that need it.

It matters from an operational perspective because a tank's engine has been developed specifically to provide mechanical energy for the movement of a heavy armoured vehicle. Using the engine to generate electricity only when the tank does not move requires fuel and adds unnecessary hours to the operation of the engine.

An APU enables the tank to stay powered without running its main engine.

In case of an armoured force that operates for extended periods, it can be seen as increased efficiency in terms of use of fuel, reduction in wear of the main engine and also low maintenance needs. The more important part is that the crew is able to maintain the electronic and weapon systems active even when the tank is at rest, making it

ready for quick action.

This is becoming increasingly important due to the fact that the existing platforms such as T-72 and T-90 are constantly being upgraded with sophisticated electronic and weapon systems. As the number of electrically powered systems on a tank increases, a reliable auxiliary power source becomes an important part of overall platform sustainability.

Also, the new contract comes with a strong message of indigenisation. According to the Ministry of Defence, the procurement of auxiliary power units is a very important step for indigenisation of critical subsystems of armoured platforms. Instead of thinking of tanks as a whole as

something that is foreign to India, one can gradually move to indigenisation of different parts of it.

APU development has been done under the Make-II category wherein India's procurement system for defence equipment encourages industry-led development and production of military equipment. The importance of the model lies in the fact that it aims at bringing the indigenous technologies past the prototype stage to actual production and integration with the armed forces.

Thus, the signing of the contract is the first step towards the process of moving from the development to the procurement phase of the indigenous technology. For the Army, the primary task is to provide a reliable means of an alternate power source for its armoured vehicles. On the part of the indigenous defence industry, the contract offers an opportunity to prove that the privately developed technology can meet the operational needs of the frontline military platform.

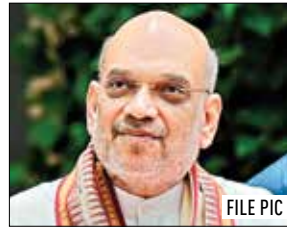
The contract also highlights that indigenisation of the defence sector is no longer confined to the big platforms like tanks, aircraft, and warships, but it is also expanding to subsystems that play a crucial role in the availability and performance of these platforms.

## HM Amit Shah to inaugurate 3rd national ANTF conference

*'Beginning today, conference to focus on drugs, darknet'*

NARESH BISWANI

New Delhi, September 21



**TOP ANTI-NARCOTICS OFFICIALS FROM ALL 36 STATES AND UTS WILL ATTEND THE 2-DAY CONFERENCE**

Union Home Minister Amit Shah will inaugurate the third National Conference of Anti-Narcotics Task Force (ANTF) Heads of States and Union Territories in New Delhi on Tuesday, with senior officials set to deliberate on ways to dismantle drug cartels and tackle emerging challenges such as synthetic drugs, darknet networks and cryptocurrencies.

The two-day conference, organised by the Narcotics Control Bureau (NCB), will bring together heads of the anti-narcotics task forces of all 36 states and Union Territories, along with representatives of various government departments and agencies.

Shah will also release television commercials aimed at creating awareness against drug abuse

and lay the foundation stones for NCB Zone headquarters in Lucknow and Dehradun. The best-performing State/UT ANTF will be felicitated during the conference, while the NCB's improved website will also be unveiled.

The conference is being held under the theme "United Resolve, Shared Responsibility" and will focus on steps to achieve the targets outlined in the Vision Document for Narcotics Control 2026-29 and strategies adopted by states and Union Territories for their effective implementation.

Eight technical sessions

have been planned around the four pillars of the Vision Document -- enforcement and operations, intelligence and operations, control of precursor and synthetic narcotic drugs, demand and harm reduction, and capacity-building and coordination.

The sessions will focus on dismantling drug networks and cartels, strengthening enforcement and prevention measures, improving treatment responses, controlling precursor chemicals, curbing illicit cultivation and addressing the use of the dark web and cryptocurrencies for drug-related activities.

## AHF invites Punjab CM to Japan

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 21

The Asian Hockey Federation (AHF) has invited Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Singh Mann and a state government delegation to Japan to witness the hockey semi-finals and finals of the Asian Games Aichi-Nagoya 2026.

The invitation, extended by AHF President Fumio Ogura, covers the women's and men's semi-finals on September

30 and October 1, followed by the finals on October 2 and 3.

The AHF said the visit would provide the Punjab delegation first-hand exposure to the organisation and conduct of a major international sporting event. The experience is expected to help the state prepare for the Men's Asian Champions Trophy 2026, which Punjab will host for the first time from October 27 to November 5.

The tournament will be jointly hosted by Jalandhar and Mohali. Jalandhar will stage the opening ceremony and league matches, while Mohali will host the semi-finals and final.

India, Japan, South Korea, Malaysia, China and other teams are expected to compete in the tournament. Mann has described the event as an emotional homecoming of hockey to Punjab, which has produced generations of Indian hockey players.

## Briefs

### NFR steps up Swachhata campaign

**MALIGAON:** North-east Frontier Railway is undertaking cleanliness and sanitation drives under the Swachhata Hi Sewa 2026 campaign from September 17 to October 2. Initiatives include riverbank cleaning, waste removal, water-tank maintenance and awareness programmes at railway schools, with participation from staff, Safai Mitras, students, Scouts & Guides and passengers.

### Assam cops seize Rs 3-cr morphine

**DIPHU:** Police seized around 3 kg of morphine worth nearly Rs 3 crore and arrested three suspected traffickers, including a woman, in Assam's Karbi Anglong district. The trio, all from Manipur, were held after their car was intercepted during routine checking in Dillai.

### Odisha: 2 killed in road mishap

**BARIPADA:** Two men were killed after their motorcycle was hit head-on by a speeding vehicle near Kaliashol village in Odisha's Mayurbhanj district on Monday, police said. Rahul Naik and Raju Naik, residents of the spot while returning from a football tournament. The vehicle driver fled.

## UP: 10 IAS officers shifted

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

Lucknow, September 21

The Uttar Pradesh government has reshuffled the responsibilities of 10 senior IAS officers, bringing changes in key departments including power, health, medical education, higher education, agriculture and food and logistics.

Additional Chief Secretary Amit Kumar Ghosh has been shifted from Medical Health and Family Welfare and Medical Education to Higher Education.

Ashish Kumar Goel, Additional Chief Secretary, Energy and Additional Energy, has been moved to Labour and Employment. He was also chairman of UPPCL, UP Power Transmission Corporation, UP State Electricity Generation Corporation and UPSLDC.

Ranveer Prasad, Principal Secretary, Food and Logistics and Consumer Affairs and Commissioner, Food and Logistics, will now head the Energy and Additional Energy departments.

V Heckali Zhimomi,

Principal Secretary, Forest and Environment and Climate Change, has been appointed Principal Secretary, Health and Family Welfare and Principal Secretary, Medical Education.

Mahendra Prasad Agrawal has been shifted from Higher Education to Forest and Environment and Climate Change. Anil Kumar has been moved from Panchayati Raj to Food and Logistics and Consumer Affairs and will also serve as Commissioner, Food and Logistics.

Amrit Abhijat, Additional Chief Secretary, Tourism, Culture and Religious Affairs, has been given additional charge of Transport. Archana Agrawal, who held the portfolio, is due to retire this month. MKS Sundaram has been shifted from Labour and Employment and Technical Education to Agriculture and related departments. Ravindra has been appointed Principal Secretary, Panchayati Raj, while Amit Gupta has been given additional charge of Principal Secretary, Technical Education.

## CISF takes over security of 3 ED offices in Mumbai

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Mumbai, September 21

The CISF on Monday took over security of three Enforcement Directorate (ED) offices in Mumbai, deploying 45 personnel as part of its expanded security cover for the agency's offices across the country.

The force currently provides security to 20 ED offices in 20 cities under its internal security duty pattern. The security deployment at the three Mumbai offices began under Senior Commandant Dhiraj Kumar Singh, CISF Mumbai Police Area. An inauguration was held at the ED office in Ceejay House, Worli, attended by senior officials of the ED and CISF.

The deployed personnel have been directed to maintain high vigilance and provide security to ED staff while assisting visitors to the offices.

## Saini accuses AAP of failing to curb 'drug menace' in Punjab

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 21

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Monday accused the AAP government in Punjab of failing to fulfil its electoral promises and alleged that the drug menace had worsened during its tenure.

Addressing an event at Sito in Fazilka district as part of the BJP's 13-day 'Nasha Mukti Punjab Yatra', Saini said the AAP had promised to eradicate drugs, provide employment to youth and ensure procurement of farmers' produce, but had failed to deliver on these commitments.

He alleged that the drug problem and Punjab's debt had increased fourfold under the AAP government and accused it of betraying women, farmers and the poor.

Saini also targeted Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann over his earlier remark that the AAP had



gained experience since coming to power. "Mann Sahib, you have gained experience in increasing the drug problem, trapping youth in drugs and increasing corruption in the state," he said.

He recalled that Mann, AAP national convener Arvind Kejriwal and senior party leader Manish Sisodia had promised to eradicate drugs within three to six months of forming the government, provide three lakh jobs and procure farmers' produce at minimum support price.

Saini challenged the three leaders to appear on

a public platform and tell Punjab's youth how many jobs had been provided and what steps had been taken to curb drugs.

Questioning Mann's claim that 71,000 people involved in the drug trade had been arrested, Saini said Punjab's prisons had a capacity of around 35,000 inmates and accused the chief minister of misleading people.

He said Punjab and Haryana were like brothers but claimed Haryana had moved ahead in development under Prime Minister Narendra Modi's "double-engine" government.

## Guv calls for unlocking HP's hidden tourism potential

ASHWANI SHARMA

Shimla, September 21

Himachal Pradesh Governor Kavinder Gupta on Monday called for a revamp of the state's tourism sector, with greater focus on unexplored destinations, local communities and sustainable development while protecting the fragile Himalayan ecology.

In his first interaction with media professionals at Lok Bhavan, Gupta said incentives should be provided to stakeholders to develop new tourism ventures and distribute economic benefits to remote communities. He said overcrowded destinations should not be allowed to witness further hotel construction.

Gupta said Himachal's potential in religious tourism remained largely untapped and cited Uttarakhand's development of religious destinations as an example. He said he was studying proposals to give tourism a decisive push and would soon meet Prime Minister Narendra Modi with concrete suggestions.

He also stressed the need to improve air connectivity to remote destinations and said he would meet Union Civil Aviation Minister Kinjarapu Rammoohan Naidu to seek assistance for the state.

Gupta, who earlier served as Deputy Chief Minister of Jammu and Kashmir, said infrastructure development and improved connectivity had accompanied a decline in violence in the Valley after the abrogation of Article 370.

On the Himachal Pradesh State Universities (Amendment) Bill, 2026, Gupta said institutions should retain autonomy despite receiving government funding. On land allotments in Lahaul-Spiti, he said proper norms should be framed.

## Punjab expands anti-drug campaign through 5-point strategy

*'Yudh Nashean Virudh' campaign reaches villages, schools, colleges and health facilities*

MPOST BUREAU

Chandigarh, September 21

Punjab's 'Yudh Nashean Virudh' campaign against drugs has expanded beyond police crackdown, with the state adopting a five-point strategy involving police, teachers, youth, community volunteers and health workers to curb drug supply, prevent addiction, improve reporting and facilitate treatment.

The campaign by the Bhagwant Mann government has reached villages, schools, colleges and health facilities. Police target drug networks, community representatives strengthen



vigilance, teachers identify vulnerability, youth promote healthier choices, and health workers support recovery.

According to officials, the campaign has resulted in the seizure of 3,918 kg

of heroin, 991 kg of opium, 47 tonnes of poppy husk, 1,416 kg of ganja and 65 lakh tablets and capsules. Police have also held 79,293 public meetings to strengthen participation.

Prevention is the sec-

## KEY POINTS

- » The state has adopted a five-point strategy involving police, teachers, youth, community volunteers and health workers
- » Police target drug networks, community representatives strengthen vigilance, teachers identify vulnerability, youth promote healthier choices, and health workers support recovery

ond pillar, with a 14-week anti-drug curriculum being taught to 7.5 lakh students in 3,600 schools. The government is also sensitising teachers to recognise vulnerability to substance abuse. In the first phase,

nearly 25,000 teachers from 13 districts are to be trained, with 7,000 already sensitised in Amritsar, Tarn Taran and Fazilka.

The third pillar focuses on peer influence and reducing acceptance of drug use. Schools have prepared activity calendars, while cultural festivals, mental-health clubs and sports activities encourage healthier lifestyles. Youth-led programmes and recovered persons are also helping reduce stigma around recovery.

The fourth pillar seeks citizen participation. By September 2026, around 1.25 lakh people had joined

nearly 15,000 Village and Ward Defence Committees, with more than 50,000 members trained to use the Nasha Mukti App. Since March 1, 2025, more than 51,000 citizen tip-offs through the Safe Punjab WhatsApp Helpline have helped police make over 25,000 drug-related arrests.

The fifth pillar focuses on treatment. Punjab has 547 OOAD centres, 219 de-addiction centres and 91 rehabilitation centres. Admissions to government de-addiction and rehabilitation facilities rose from over 12,200 in 2024 to nearly 34,000 in 2025, an increase of more than 170 per cent.



EDITORIAL

Beyond the Assembly Line

India’s manufacturing story has acquired impressive scale. Electronics production rose from Rs 1.9 lakh crore in 2014-15 to Rs 13.11 lakh crore in 2025-26, while exports climbed from a little over Rs 38,000 crore to Rs 4.24 lakh crore. Mobile phones, electronics, automobiles and increasingly sophisticated industrial products are rolling out of Indian factories in far greater numbers. Global companies are expanding production in the country, supply chains are taking shape around new manufacturing clusters, and India is emerging as an important alternative production base. Yet beneath these achievements lies a weakness that must now become the focus of manufacturing policy: India often assembles much more than it actually makes.

The distinction matters. A factory that imports high-value components and puts them together domestically certainly creates employment, develops logistics networks, builds manufacturing experience and allows Indian workers and companies to participate in global supply chains. Assembly can also be an important first stage in industrialisation. Countries rarely develop complex manufacturing ecosystems overnight. But assembly cannot be the final destination. The greater and more durable economic gains come when the components, machinery, materials, designs, technologies and intellectual property embedded in the finished product are progressively produced at home. This is also where manufacturing begins to create stronger multiplier effects. A domestic component supplier employs workers, purchases materials, invests in machinery and develops engineering capabilities of its own. As more such suppliers emerge, manufacturers gain access to a deeper local ecosystem, reducing lead times and improving resilience. Knowledge spreads across companies, workers acquire specialised skills and smaller firms gain opportunities to enter sophisticated supply chains. Manufacturing then becomes an ecosystem rather than a collection of assembly plants.

India remains dependent on imports for several critical inputs. In electronics alone, printed circuit boards, camera and display modules, connectors, capacitors, lithium-ion cells and rare-earth magnets remain among the areas where import dependence persists. The broader manufacturing sector also continues to rely substantially on imported technologically advanced capital equipment. Much of this dependence is linked to China, which supplied India with goods worth about \$132 billion in 2025-26. As domestic production expands, imports of components and machinery can rise alongside it, exposing the limits of measuring manufacturing success primarily through the value of finished goods leaving factories. This does not mean India should attempt to manufacture everything within its borders. No successful modern industrial economy functions without global supply chains. Components cross borders repeatedly before becoming finished products, and specialisation is central to efficient manufacturing. Nor should self-reliance become a justification for expensive protectionism that leaves domestic companies insulated from competition. High tariffs may encourage local production in some areas, but permanent protection can also raise costs, weaken competitiveness and ultimately hurt exporters.

The objective must instead be strategic depth: identifying components and technologies where excessive external dependence creates economic or national-security vulnerabilities and developing competitive domestic alternatives. India needs to decide where localisation can generate technological capability and scale, rather than pursuing localisation simply for its own sake. There are encouraging signs of such a shift. The Electronics Components Manufacturing Scheme is explicitly aimed at moving deeper into the value chain, including components, sub-assemblies and capital equipment. The semiconductor push is similarly widening attention beyond fabrication and packaging towards equipment, materials, gases, chemicals and substrates. These are precisely the less visible layers on which durable manufacturing ecosystems are built. Their success will determine whether India captures a larger share of value or remains concentrated at the relatively thinner assembly end of global production networks.

But incentives alone cannot create industrial depth. India needs patient investment in tooling, precision engineering, materials science, industrial research and supplier development. Smaller manufacturers must be able to meet the quality, scale and delivery standards demanded by global companies. Affordable finance, reliable infrastructure and skilled technical workers are equally important. Universities, laboratories and industry need stronger links so that research can move more quickly towards commercial application. Government procurement can also help promising domestic technologies acquire scale, provided it does not become a mechanism for shielding inefficient producers indefinitely.

The next measure of manufacturing success should therefore not simply be how many phones, cars or machines India produces. It should increasingly be how much Indian engineering, technology, intellectual property and value they contain. Production-linked incentives helped bring factories and scale. The next generation of industrial policy must ensure that more suppliers, technologies and capabilities grow around them. Assembly gave India an entry into global manufacturing. The harder and more consequential task now is to move from assembling the world’s products to making more of what goes inside them.

Before the Heart Sounds the Alarm

India’s heart-health challenge demands earlier detection, stronger primary care and technology that reaches patients before emergencies strike

ILLNESS TO WELLNESS



ANIL RAJPUT

THE WRITER IS THE CHAIRPERSON, ADVISORY COUNCIL, ILLNESS TO WELLNESS FOUNDATION



From AI to everyday awareness, cardiac care is moving beyond the walls of hospitals

A heart attack may feel sudden, but is the risk really sudden at all? Often, the real story begins years earlier. Long before an ambulance is called or a patient enters a cardiac care unit, the body may have been carrying high blood pressure, abnormal cholesterol, diabetes, arterial damage or other risks for years, often without obvious symptoms. That is why the World Heart Federation’s message for World Heart Day 2026, “Don’t Miss a Beat”, remains so relevant. The campaign reminds us that heart disease can hide in plain sight and calls for greater attention to symptoms, prevention, and the systems that enable timely care.

Last year, I wrote about the scale of India’s cardiovascular challenge and the importance of early detection. This year, perhaps we need to take that thought one step further and ask how early can “early” become?

The future of heart health cannot begin only when a person reaches an emergency room. It has to begin in homes, workplaces, neighbourhood clinics and primary health centres, where risk can be recognised before it becomes a crisis. It also requires us to rethink what innovation means. The future is certainly being shaped by artificial intelligence, connected diagnostics and new medical devices, but some of the most important innovations are simpler. They include linking smaller hospitals to specialists, standardising treatment, training first responders and ensuring that the right decision can be taken quickly wherever a patient happens to live.

India is already showing what this can look like. Karnataka’s statewide STEMI programme has connected rural hospitals to specialist cardiac hubs through connected ECG machines, artificial intelligence, telecardiology and cloud-based tracking. According to NITI Aayog’s Frontier Tech platform, more than 11.77 lakh patients were screened between March 2023 and February 2026. The programme achieved a median door-to-needle time of just 13 minutes for eligible heart attack patients, while specialist confirmation could be obtained remotely rather than waiting

for a cardiologist to be physically present at every facility.

The significance goes beyond technology. A nurse or doctor in a smaller hospital can perform an ECG, transmit it, receive specialist guidance and begin treatment while referral is being arranged. In a cardiac emergency, where every delay matters, bringing expertise to the patient may sometimes be as important as bringing the patient to expertise.

A recent Indian analysis provides another glimpse of this model. More than 45,000 AI-assisted ECGs were performed across 66 spoke centres connected to 10 hubs in six states. Critical ECGs had an average diagnostic turnaround time of under three minutes. Artificial intelligence here is not a substitute for clinical judgement. Its value lies in helping identify potentially dangerous patterns quickly and directing specialist attention to patients who may need it most.

Even the humble stethoscope is being reimaged. Researchers at MNNIT Prayagraj recently developed a patented AI-enabled stethoscope designed to analyse heart sounds and assist in identifying valvular heart disease in real time, particularly with an eye on resource-limited settings. Such technologies are still emerging and must prove their value through rigorous clinical use, but they demonstrate an important direction for Indian innovation. The aim is to make advanced screening more accessible rather than restricting it to major hospitals.

Tamil Nadu offers another lesson. Its government-supported heart attack network linked 18 medical college hospitals with catheterisation facilities to 188 district and taluk hospitals. Between 2019 and 2023, the network treated 71,907 people with ST-elevation myocardial infarction, or STEMI. Telemedicine enabled clinicians at smaller centres to share ECGs and obtain guidance from cardiologists at hub hospitals, while access to appropriate cardiac intervention improved.

WORLD HEART DAY BRINGS RENEWED FOCUS TO PREVENTION, AWARENESS AND TIMELY ACTION

The lesson is important. Innovation is not always the invention of a new treatment. Sometimes it is ensuring that a treatment we already know works reaches the patient in time.

India is also contributing to technologies used inside cardiac centres themselves. The Indian-developed Myval transcatheter heart valve, for example, was tested against an established international valve in a large randomised trial involving more than 1,000 patients and was found to be non-inferior on the study’s main one-year outcome. This matters because a stronger culture of indigenous medical innovation can help India become not merely a user of advanced cardiovascular technology, but increasingly a developer of solutions relevant to its own scale, affordability needs and clinical realities.

Yet we should be careful not to confuse innovation with gadgets alone. One of the biggest cardiovascular opportunities remains one of the least dramatic. It is controlling high blood pressure. Hypertension can quietly damage the arteries, heart, brain and kidneys for years. A smart watch may tell us more about our bodies, but it cannot replace knowing our blood pressure, following prescribed treatment consistently, remaining physically active and paying attention to diabetes, cholesterol, weight management, sleep, stress and balanced nutrition.

This is where international experience becomes particularly useful.

Chile and the wider HEARTS initiative in the Americas show what can happen when hypertension management is made systematic rather than complicated. The approach emphasises standard treatment protocols, access to medicines, team-based care and regular monitoring. In one Chilean study, 65 per cent of patients treated under a simplified standardised protocol reached their blood pressure target after one year, compared with 37 to 41 per cent under usual care. Across HEARTS in the Americas, more than four million people are now receiving standardised hypertension treatment, with 62 per cent achieving blood pressure control.

India’s lesson is not to copy another country’s health system, but to recognise the power of consistency. Millions of individual consultations become far more effective when primary care follows clear protocols and patients are not lost between diagnosis, treatment and follow-up.

Denmark offers a different lesson. Heart health is also a civic skill. Basic life-support training has been required for people obtaining driving licences, helping make CPR knowledge far more widespread. Research covering out-of-hospital cardiac arrests between 2005 and 2019 found that greater participation in basic life-support courses was associated with increased bystander CPR and improved 30-day survival.

For India, CPR and automated external defibrillator awareness should increasingly become part of schools, colleges, workplaces, housing societies, airports, railway stations, sports facilities and other public spaces. We should not assume that only a doctor can save a life in the first few minutes of a cardiac arrest. A heart emergency can happen anywhere, which means the first link in the chain of survival is often an ordinary citizen standing nearby.

Finland’s North Karelia experience reminds us

of something even broader. Beginning in the 1970s, a population-wide effort focused on major cardiovascular risk factors through community action, health services, public awareness and preventive care. Over the following decades, coronary mortality among middle-aged people fell dramatically. The deeper lesson is that cardiovascular prevention cannot rest entirely on individual discipline. Access to preventive care, opportunities for physical activity, health literacy and the environments in which people work and live all influence heart health.

This balance is essential. We need advanced cardiac centres, but we also need healthier communities. We need artificial intelligence, but we also need human awareness. We need faster emergency networks, but we also need fewer people reaching the point at which an emergency response becomes necessary.

For individuals, the message can be kept simple. Know, notice and act. Know your blood pressure, blood sugar, cholesterol and family history. Notice unusual chest pressure, unexplained breathlessness, palpitations, fainting, persistent fatigue or other changes, and remember that cardiovascular symptoms do not always appear in the same way in every person. Act on risk before symptoms force you to.

Heart health is also built through everyday choices. Regular physical activity, balanced nutrition, adequate sleep, stress management, routine health checks and adherence to prescribed treatment can all contribute to reducing cardiovascular risk. None of these actions is dramatic in isolation, but their value lies in consistency. Wellness is rarely created by one major decision. More often, it is shaped by the smaller decisions repeated over time.

At the Illness to Wellness Foundation, our purpose is not only to create awareness about illness but to encourage the habits, knowledge and systems that make wellness possible. World Heart Day gives us an opportunity to move the conversation from fear of heart disease towards practical ownership of heart health. Prevention is not a single health check on 29 September. It is a relationship with our health that continues throughout the year.

The next era of cardiovascular care will be defined not simply by how sophisticated our hospitals become, but by how successfully we connect prevention, primary care, technology, emergency response and informed citizens. If we can recognise risk sooner, respond faster and make healthier choices easier to sustain, many cardiac emergencies need never become emergencies at all.

Let us not wait for our heart to tell us something is wrong before we begin to listen. The best time to protect it is before it has to sound the alarm.

Views expressed are personal

LETTER



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Press Freedom

President Donald Trump’s defence of barring CNN, MS NOW and Politico from the White House raises troubling questions about press freedom. Governments do not strengthen democracy by deciding which journalists deserve access based on whether their coverage is favourable. Branding critical reporting “fake news” cannot become a licence to exclude news organisations. A free press must be able to question those in power without fearing retaliation. The White House should welcome scrutiny, not restrict it.

SAMAY KHANNA, MUMBAI

You can also send your comments to The Editor, Millennium Post, Pratap Bhawan, 5 Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi 110 002

Preventing The Next Disaster



DIYA CHATTERJEE

Nepal’s decision to form a 15-member parliamentary special committee to study the Rasuwa floods is an important step towards accountability, but its value will depend on what follows. Parliamentary inquiries should go beyond documenting losses and identify weaknesses in disaster preparedness, early-warning systems, infrastructure planning and emergency response.

For a country repeatedly exposed to floods, landslides and other climate-related hazards, lessons from one disaster must shape preparations for the next. The committee should work transparently, consult affected communities and experts, and produce practical recommendations with clear timelines. An inquiry matters only when its findings translate into safer communities.



News at a glance

Gold mine collapse in northeast Sudan kills 11

**SHENDI:** A gold mine shaft collapsed in north-eastern Sudan, killing at least 11 miners and injuring 30, a state official said, while a search continued for the missing under the debris.

The incident, which took place on Sunday, was the second collapse of an informal gold mine in Sudan in a week.

The mines are among thousands of small-scale and informal mines scattered across Sudan, which has been engulfed in a war that has at times pushed parts of the country into famine.

Pope Leo in France to find a secular country at odds

**VATICAN:** When an ailing Pope John Paul II visited the French shrine at Lourdes in 2004, on his last foreign trip, he delivered a forceful condemnation of abortion and euthanasia as he gasped for air during Mass.

Pope Leo XIV is expected to make a similar appeal to protect life when he visits France this weekend and also prays at Lourdes. One of Christianity’s most-visited pilgrimage destinations is especially popular for sick people because of its association with miraculous cures.

Canada: 2 Indian students killed during flight training

**TORONTO:** Two Indian students have been killed in a tragic air accident in Canada during their flight training, the Indian mission has said.

“The Consulate General of India, Vancouver, expresses its deepest condolences on the tragic demise of Shri Manoj Sivakumar and Shri Srisaran Thirugnanasambantham, two Indian students from Tamil Nadu and Puducherry, who lost their lives in a tragic air accident in Canada during their flight training,” the mission said.



An ultra-Orthodox Jewish man whips a member of his Hasidic dynasty, during Malkot ceremony

Main Kremlin party keeps control of Russian Parl

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
Moscow, Sept 21

The main Kremlin party retained its majority in Russia’s parliament, election officials said Monday.

Preliminary results indicated that United Russia would get 355 out of 450 seats in the State Duma, the lower chamber of parliament, the Central Election Commission said, which would be a record high for the party if confirmed.

AS PLANET GRAPPLES WITH WAR, DIVISION AND CLIMATE SHOCKS

World leaders meet at United Nations

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
United Nations, September 21

Under a global cloud of wars and bitter divisions, world leaders meet at the United Nations this week facing new fears that runaway artificial intelligence could threaten humanity even as climate shocks and escalating prices are already making life much tougher for hundreds of millions of people.

The annual high-level gathering at the UN General Assembly will also be consumed with major wars in Iran, Gaza, Ukraine,Sudan, Congo and Myanmar and a persisting question: Can the leaders do anything to end them?



Representational Image

And what can they do about the relentless rise of global warming threatening the future of the planet, the growing inequalities within and among nations, and shocks to the global economy as blocked shipping

routes and supply chains increase the cost of living and slow growth?

The future of the United Nations will also definitely be on the agenda

At 81, its powers are still the victorious nations from

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The future of the UN will also definitely be on the agenda
- » The UN’s 193 member nations have agreed to a wide-ranging reform package that includes updating key institutions such as the powerful UN Security Council
- » Some 130 heads of state and government are expected to speak at the General Assembly

World War II, not the 21st century’s major global players. The UN’s 193 member nations have agreed to a wide-ranging reform package that includes updating key institutions such as the powerful UN Security Council, where the US, Russia, China, Britain and France hold inordinate sway

because of their veto power. Reform, however, is easier said than implemented.

Behind the scenes, there will be speculation about who will lead the United Nations next. Secretary-General Antonio Guterres’ second five-year term ends Dec. 31 and no clear successor has emerged.

Xi to visit US tomorrow for talks with Trump

China calls the President’s visit ‘milestone of historic significance’

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Moscow, September 21

Chinese President Xi Jinping will visit Washington from September 23 to 25 for summit talks with his US counterpart Donald Trump, marking their second meeting in four months, a development Beijing has described as a “milestone of historic significance”.

Xi will visit the US for three days at the invitation of Trump, Foreign Ministry spokesperson Guo Jiakun announced at a media briefing here on Monday.

During his talks with Trump, Xi will have in-



Chinese President Xi Jinping

depth exchanges on key issues concerning China-US relations, as well as world peace and development, Guo said.

“The reciprocal visits by the two heads of state within a span of six months will mark a milestone of historic significance,” he said.

SPORT

ASIAN GAMES

Indian men’s 10m air rifle trio strikes team silver



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Nagoya, September 21

If confidence, process and camaraderie have become the defining traits of India’s new generation of shooters, Rudranksh Patil, Himanshu Dhillon and Parth Mane offered another compelling demonstration of it by clinching the men’s 10m air rifle team silver at the Asian Games here on Monday.

The young trio combined with poise and consistency to give India its second team medal in as many days, taking the country’s shooting tally to three silvers.

With the men’s individual 10m air rifle final still to come later in the day, the medal count could swell further.

Former world champion Rudranksh, 22, once again underlined why he is regarded as one of India’s finest 10m rifle exponents since Abhinav Bindra. Alongside 20-year-old Himanshu and teen-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The young trio combined with poise and consistency to give India its second team medal in as many days
- » Former world champion Rudranksh, 22, once again underlined why he is regarded as one of India’s finest 10m rifle exponents since Abhinav Bindra

ager Mane, he helped India post an aggregate of 1890.1 points, finishing behind a formidable Chinese side that produced a second world record in as many days.

China amassed 1899.0 points to improve on its own world record of 1898.4, set in Cairo last year.

South Korea mounted a strong challenge but had to settle for bronze with 1884.2 points.

Yet, amid the numbers and the record-breaking

performance from China, it was the composure of the Indian trio – particularly debutant Mane – that stood out.

Only 18 and competing at his maiden Asian Games, Mane looked remarkably unfazed in what was a pressure-filled environment.

The junior World medalist stayed within himself, trusted his routine and produced the kind of performance that helped India remain firmly in the medal hunt.

Rudranksh finished third in the individual qualification standings with 631.8 points, while Himanshu was seventh with 630.0.

Mane, with 628.3, narrowly missed the eight-shooter individual final, but his contribution proved crucial as the aggregate scores from the qualification round determine the team medals.

For Mane, the medal was also a reward for a journey that began almost by accident.

Indian women’s TT team sweeps aside Pakistan 3-0 to enter QFs

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Toyota, September 21

India’s women’s and men’s table tennis teams advanced to the quarter-finals of the Asian Games following identical 3-0 wins over their respective Pakistani rivals, here on Monday.

The women team swept aside Pakistan 3-0 in a one-sided tie to top Group F for its third win in a row while the men’s team also bounced back for the same scoreline.

At the Sky Hall here, Sutirtha Mukherjee got India off to a flying start, beating Aleena Khan 11-3, 11-3, 11-4 in just 10 minutes.

Deepika, Rutuja, Navneet score hat-tricks to power India to 17-1 win over Indonesia

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Kakamigahara, Sept 21

The troika of destructive young forward Deepika Sehrawat, Rutuja Dadaso Pisal and Navneet Kaur fired a hat-trick each as the Indian women’s hockey team hammered Indonesia 17-1 to register its second consecutive Pool B win at the Asian Games here on Monday.

The 22-year-old Deepika (8th, 28th, 40th minutes), who scored eight goals in India’s 19-0 drubbing of Uzbekistan in the lung-opener, converted three penalty corners, while Rutuja (15th, 20th, 38th) found the net thrice from field play.

Navneet’s goals came in the 35th, 56th and 57th minutes.

In addition, Sunelita



Toppo (11th, 30th), Lalremsiami (12th, 16th) and Sakshi Rana (25th, 57th), scored a brace each while skipper Salima Tete (35th) Ishika Chaudhary (36th) also found the net once. Indonesia’s solitary goal was scored

by Innes Aditiya in the 32nd minute. India will next take on Thailand on Wednesday.

After the resounding 19-0 thrashing of Uzbekistan on Sunday, the Indians made a steady start.

India had the first

IT WAS DEEPIKA WHO GAVE INDIA THE LEAD BY CONVERTING A PENALTY CORNER IN THE EIGHTH MINUTE

chance in the fourth minute in the form of a penalty stroke but Navneet’s attempt was saved by the Indonesia goalkeeper.

It was Deepika who gave India the lead by converting a penalty corner in the eighth minute.

The goal opened the floodgates as Sunelita doubled the lead three minutes later, tapping in a pass from Neha. Two minutes after that, Lalremsiami scored from a rebound after Deepika’s flick from a set piece was saved by the Indonesian custodian.

Zaheer Khan becomes new CSK head coach

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Chennai, September 21

Chennai Super Kings on Monday named former India pace great Zaheer Khan as their new head coach for the upcoming season.

Zaheer replaced Stephen Fleming, who was at helm for 18 seasons.

“Welcoming Zaheer Khan as the Head Coach of Chennai Super Kings,” CSK announced on ‘X’.

“It’s an honour to be a part of one of the most successful teams in the history of the IPL. As a cricketer, I have faced CSK on the field and have thoroughly enjoyed the

I CAN’T WAIT TO JOIN THE LEGACY FRANCHISE WITH SUCH A RICH HISTORY

contests. The atmosphere created by the Superfans at Chepauk make it even more special,” Zaheer was quoted as saying in a press release issued by the franchise.

“I can’t wait to join the legacy franchise with such a rich history.” The soon-to-be 48 Zaheer played 92 Tests, 200 ODIs and 17 T20Is for India. He was the highest wicket-taker during the historic 2011

World Cup campaign with 21 scalps.

Zaheer had mentored the Lucknow Super Giants during the 2024 season.

Fleming had announced last year in July that he was parting ways with the five-time champion side.

It is understood that CSK’s cricket management committee comprises MS Dhoni, skipper Ruturaj Gaikwad and owner Rupa Gurunath wanted an Indian coach this time.

In the IPL, Zaheer played 100 matches and turned to coaching roles post his retirement.

# Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited

(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)

(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)

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## NOTICE INVITING TENDER (1<sup>st</sup> call) (Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

No.: 28 /CSIDC/E.E./Division-I/2026-27/

Raipur, Dated 16 /09/2026

Online tenders are invited in Form-B (Item rate basis) from “A” class electrical license contractor registered in Class-D & Above in New Unified Registration System (E-Registration) website <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> at appropriate class, for the following works:-

| S. No. | Name of Work                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Registered Contractor in CGPWD or in appropriate class in other dep't. | Time allowed including rainy season | Estimated Cost (INR Lacs) | EMD (INR Rs.) | Cost of Tender Doc. (INR) including GST 18% |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|---------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------|
| 1.     | Annual Operation, Repair/ Maintenance/ Inspection & Security of Street Lighting/ High Mast Lighting System at I/A Sirgitti, Tifra, Silpahari Bilaspur and Periodical Repairing & Maintenance of Street Lights at Various I/A Nayanpur- Girwarganj (Surajpur) Gangaparkhurd (Ambikapur), Anjani Pendra Road, Kapan(Janjgir- Champa), Aurethi Bhatapara and Khamharia (Mungeli) (C.G.) | D & Above                                                              | 12 Months                           | 59.04 Lacs                | 44,500/-      | 3540/-                                      |

The tender document and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in> from 18/09/2026 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

**NOTE:** 1) The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG eProc Helpdesk. Operated by Mjunction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18002582502 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at [Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in](mailto:Helpdesk.eproc@cgswan.gov.in).

2) Tenderer may contact to E.E., Div-IV, CSIDC, Udyog Bhawan in working hours to clear their doubt if any before online submission of the tender

**Executive Engineer,**

Division-I

samvad 49116/3



News at a glance

EAF project: Tata Steel seeks talks with UK govt over delay

NEW DELHI: Tata Steel is seeking discussions with the UK government over issues delaying timely implementation of its electric arc furnace (EAF) project at Port Talbot, CEO T V Narendran said. Narendran said there was no delay from Tata Steel in constructing the 3.2 MT project, being developed at an investment of 1.25 billion pounds. The project faces delays in securing power supply. Tata Steel expects electricity access for the EAF by 2029. The project has 500 million pounds of government support & aims to cut site-level CO2 emissions by 90 per cent, equivalent to 5 MT annually.

Govt asks Microsoft to locate data centres near power sites

NEW DELHI: The government on Monday asked Microsoft to locate future data centres closer to power generation sources rather than cable landing stations, saying this would reduce costs for the company & country. Electronics & IT Secretary S Krishnan said building data centres near power sources was more economical. Microsoft launched its fourth India cloud region in Hyderabad as part of its \$20.5 billion investment commitment in digital and AI infrastructure. The India South Central region joins existing regions in Pune, Chennai and Mumbai.

RBI sells ₹25,000 crore G-secs in 2nd OMO tranche

MUMBAI: The RBI on Monday accepted bids worth Rs 25,000 crore in the second tranche of its open market operation (OMO) sale of government securities (G-secs) to absorb surplus liquidity. It accepted Rs 11,512 crore of the 6.10 per cent GS 2031, Rs 8,758 crore of the 7.95 per cent GS 2032, Rs 2,300 crore of the 6.75 per cent GS 2029, Rs 2,250 crore of the 7.17 per cent GS 2030 and Rs 180 crore of the 7.17 per cent GS 2028. No bids were accepted for the 8.28 per cent GS 2027. The final Rs 25,000 crore tranche scheduled for September 28.

DRI seizes over 845 kilogram contraband, arrests 15 persons

NEW DELHI: The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) seized over 845 kg of contraband and arrested 15 persons in multiple intelligence-led operations nationwide, the Finance Ministry said. Seizures included around 6 kg charas/hashish, around 801 kg cannabis, including 752.3 kg ganja/cannabis packed in 737 packets, 5.8 kg cocaine in nine packets, and 4.5 kg Amphetamine type stimulants. Two female passengers were intercepted at Gorakhpur Railway Station, while five persons were arrested in three amphetamine-related operations. The cocaine was seized at IGI Airport, New Delhi.

THE CATEGORY FOR QIBs GARNERED 12.68 TIMES SUBSCRIPTION

NSE IPO subscribed nearly 6 times, attracts about ₹90,300 cr of demand

The portion for non-institutional investors was subscribed 6.55 times. The retail investors’ portion was booked 1.39 times

OUR CORRESPONDENT

New Delhi, September 21

The Rs 22,569-crore initial public offering of the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE), the country’s second-largest IPO, received nearly 6 times subscription on the final day on Monday, led strong demand from institutional buyers.

The offering is India’s second-largest public issue after Hyundai Motor India’s Rs 27,870-crore IPO in 2024. The IPO surpassed LIC’s Rs 21,000 crore offering in 2022 but remains below Hyundai Motor India’s record public offer so far.

The NSE IPO received bids for 50.58 crore (50,58,11,384) shares against 8.86 crore (8,86,42,911) shares on offer, for a 5.71-times subscription, according to BSE data.

The category for Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIBs) garnered 12.68 times subscription, while the portion for non-institutional investors was subscribed 6.55 times. The retail investors’ portion was booked 1.39 times.

Indian Oil board clears ₹2,449 crore Kochi-Kanyakumari-Thoothukudi pipeline

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, September 21

The board of directors of Indian Oil Corporation (IOC) has approved an investment of Rs 2,448.70 crore for the construction and operation of a 424.65-km natural gas pipeline connecting Kochi in Kerala with Thoothukudi in Tamil Nadu, according to a regulatory filing on Monday.

The Kochi-Kanyakumari-Thoothukudi Pipeline (KTPL) will run from Kochi to Thoothukudi and have a system capacity, including common-carrier capacity, of 6.84 million standard cubic metres a day (mmscmd), the company said.

At least 1.71 mmscmd of the pipeline’s capacity will be available as common-carrier capacity, allowing third parties access to the network in line with applicable regulations.

The investment approval was granted at the board meeting held on Monday, the company said.

The project will boost the natural gas pipeline network along India’s southern coast, connecting gas infrastructure in Kerala with demand centres in southern Tamil Nadu.



The mega IPO generated nearly Rs 90,300 crore of demand against the Rs 22,568 crore issue size. The IPO was fully subscribed on the second day of bidding on Friday.

The NSE on Wednesday last week raised Rs 6,746 crore from anchor investors, including state-owned Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), Goldman Sachs and Fidelity.

Additionally, sovereign wealth funds such as GIC Singapore, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority (ADIA) and Norges Bank, as well as Eastspring and HSBC Global Asset Management, also participated in the anchor round.

The IPO comprises an Offer for Sale (OFS) of up to 12.64 crore equity shares by existing shareholders. The exchange has fixed

a price band of Rs 1,700-1,785 per equity share for the IPO. At the upper end, it will command a valuation of up to Rs 4.42 lakh crore. Since the offering is entirely an OFS, proceeds from the share sale will accrue to existing shareholders, not the NSE.

NSE shares are expected to make their market debut on September 24. The public issue marks

KEY POINTS

- » NSE IPO received bids for 50.58 crore (50,58,11,384) shares against 8.86 crore (8,86,42,911) shares on offer, for a 5.71-times subscription, according to the BSE data
- » The NSE on Wednesday last week raised Rs 6,746 crore from anchor investors, including state-owned Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC), Goldman Sachs and Fidelity
- » NSE shares are expected to make their market debut on September 24. The public issue marks a significant milestone for the NSE, whose listing plans had remained stalled for nearly a decade

a significant milestone for the NSE, whose listing plans had remained stalled for nearly a decade amid regulatory hurdles, including those linked to the co-location controversy.

The reduction in the OFS size from the earlier planned 14.9 crore shares has brought down the overall issue size from the initial estimate of around Rs 30,000 crore.

Stocks of Tata Group firms under pressure as rift between Tata Trusts-Tata Sons deepens

AGENCIES

New Delhi, September 21

Most Tata Group stocks remained under pressure during the early hours of Monday’s trading session as the dispute between Tata Trusts and Tata Sons over the leadership and future structure of the conglomerate escalated, with investors closely watching the possibility of legal proceedings & renewed uncertainty around Tata Sons’ listing.

As of 1224 IST, Tata Capital fell nearly 3 per cent at

Rs 341, while Tata Power declined 2.5 per cent to Rs 365.55. Tata Investment Corporation fell 2.3 per cent to Rs 685.90 and Tata Technologies slipped 2.2 per cent to Rs 707. Tata Elxsi declined 2 per cent to Rs 3,268, touching a fresh 52-week low. Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles was down around 1 per cent at Rs 301, while Tata Motors Commercial Vehicles fell 1 per cent. Tata Communications declined 1.5 per cent to Rs 1,746.80 and Tata Teleservices was down 1.4

per cent at Rs 35.25. Despite a negative sentiment, the Nifty 50 major, TCS traded in the green and was up nearly 1 per cent at Rs 2,122.50 on the National Stock Exchange.

The immediate trigger is a dispute over Tata Sons Chairman N Chandrasekaran’s reappointment. The Tata Sons board approved a fresh five-year term for Chandrasekaran on September 17 in a 4:1 vote. One out of the two directors voted against the resolution to reappoint Chandrasek-

aran, Tata Trusts said in a statement on Sunday. But the Trusts alleged that despite this, Tata Sons board went ahead with its decision to reappoint him for another five years on the basis of a casting vote.

Tata Trusts has challenged the Tata Sons decision, arguing one of its two nominees opposed the resolution and the chairman’s casting vote cannot override requirements. The dispute also revives focus on Tata Sons’ listing and ownership structure.

Jute manufacturers to see 15% volume growth in FY27: Report

A revival in domestic demand, improving export prospects & softer raw jute prices are likely to drive growth

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

Mumbai, September 21

Jute manufacturers are expected to witness sales volume growth of 15 per cent this financial year, supported by stronger demand and a favourable cost environment, a Crisil Ratings report said on Monday.

India’s jute industry is set for a meaningful recovery this fiscal after two challenging years marked by weak demand, high raw material costs and pressure on profitability, the report

said. A revival in domestic demand, improving export prospects and softer raw jute prices are expected to drive growth, improve profitability and support the industry’s credit profiles.

It said sales volumes are projected to grow around 15 per cent this fiscal year, reversing an annualised decline of around 10 per cent over the previous two fiscals. The recovery is expected to be supported by stronger demand and a more favourable cost environment, it added.

CLOSER LOOK

- » The report further said domestic demand is projected to increase about 20 per cent this fiscal, reversing a cumulative decline at a similar pace over the preceding two years
- » The downturn was largely triggered by a sharp rise in raw jute prices, which manufacturers passed on to customers, dampening demand & prompting a shift towards lower-cost alternatives

The report further said domestic demand is projected to increase about 20 per cent this fiscal, reversing a cumulative decline at a similar pace over the preceding two years.

The downturn was

largely triggered by a sharp rise in raw jute prices, which manufacturers passed on to customers, dampening demand and prompting a shift towards lower-cost alternative packaging materials, it said.

With input costs now moderating, product prices are expected to soften, supporting a recovery in demand. The rating agency said that export demand is also beginning to show signs of improvement.

Growth in downstream sectors such as home textiles, lifestyle products and other value-added jute applications is expected to support exports.

In addition, the rationalisation of US tariffs from the elevated levels seen last fiscal could improve the com-

petitiveness of Indian jute products in global markets.

“While improving demand will support revenue growth, profitability is likely to receive an even larger boost from easing raw material costs.

Better crop output has improved domestic availability of raw jute and led to softer prices despite subdued imports. This is significant because raw jute accounts for 60-65 per cent of the industry’s operating expenses.

Lower fibre costs and

improved capacity utilisation should drive up profitability. Consequently, operating margins are projected to expand by 130 basis points (bps) to nearly 9 per cent in FY27, Crisil Ratings Senior Director Rahul Guha said.

Raw jute prices had risen by more than 10 per cent last fiscal because of supply constraints; however, higher minimum support prices encouraged farmers to increase acreage, resulting in better crop output this year.



BUT TRADE REMAINS HEAVILY TILTED IN BEIJING’S FAVOUR

# India boosts manufactured goods exports to China, electronics shine

AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 21

India is selling more manufactured goods to China, with electronics emerging as a bright spot in a trade relationship that remains overwhelmingly tilted in Beijing’s favour.

Indian exports to China rose almost 40 per cent in the five months through August, an analysis of government data shows, with electronics and engineering goods among the biggest drivers. Industry executives in India say demand created by the global AI and data-center build-out is contributing to some of the growth, *Bloomberg* reported.

The figures show exports to China tripled to \$3.18 billion in the fiscal year ended March, driven by products including printed circuit board assemblies, smartphones, display modules and telecom equipment.

Electronics shipments have continued to rise this fiscal year, climbing more than 15 per cent in the April-August period from a



year earlier.

The increase, however, comes off a relatively low base and has done little to narrow India’s vast trade imbalance with its neighbor.

“The surge in exports to China is partly driven by pressure on suppliers to meet the demand for high-end equipment required for AI-related products and as data centers proliferate,” said Rajoo Goel, secretary general of the Electronic Industries Association of India. “This has encouraged exports of electronics from India to China.”

For New Delhi, the recent gains offer some support for a years-long effort to expand manufac-

turing and secure a bigger role in global supply chains. It also comes as India and China seek to repair relations from a multi-decade low, while Washington’s tariff policies give the two governments another incentive to deepen economic engagement.

“It shows that Indian manufacturing is beginning to win credibility in one of the world’s most competitive global value chains,” said Pankaj Mohindroo, chairman of Indian Cellular & Electronics Association.

The increase in exports, while still small, suggests Beijing may be becoming more receptive to Indian goods in the current geopolitical environment, said

KEY POINTS

» Indian exports to China rose almost 40% in the five months through August, an analysis of govt data shows

» Electronics shipments have continued to rise this fiscal year, climbing more than 15 per cent in the April-August period from a year earlier

Arun Kumar Garodia, managing director at Corona Steel Industry Pvt. There is an important wrinkle in the numbers, however.

Chinese customs data don’t record a comparable increase in printed circuit boards arriving from India, with much of the rise instead showing up under smartphones and other telecom products. Differences is how the two countries classify goods probably make it difficult to determine precisely what is behind the increase, according to industry executives.

Besides, China remains a relatively small destination for Indian goods, accounting for 4.4 per cent of

exports in the year-ended March, compared with just over 3 per cent a year earlier. The US, India’s biggest market, takes almost a fifth.

The recent gains in exports also barely dent the imbalance between Asia’s two biggest economies. India imported \$131.6 billion of Chinese goods in the year ended March, accounting for almost 17 per cent of its imports and vastly exceeding the value of goods it sold to China.

Yet, exporters are confident Indian shipment to China will continue to grow. The latest figures showed the gains extended beyond electronics. Engineering exports to China increased about 21 per cent in the April-August period from a year earlier, including machinery and parts, auto components and hand tools, according to exporters. “The task now is to sustain these exports and expand across components, sub-assemblies and finished products, while deepening Indian design and component capabilities,” Mohindroo added.

## Nine key infra sectors’ growth eases to three-month low of 4.8% in Aug

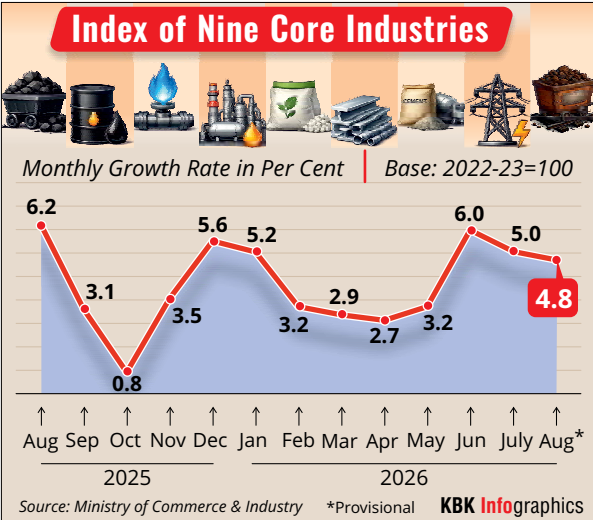
OUR CORRESPONDENT  
New Delhi, September 21

The output of nine key infrastructure sectors slowed down to a three-month low of 4.8 per cent in August due to a fall in the production of coal, natural gas, crude oil, and fertiliser, according to the government data released on Monday.

The output expanded by 6.2 per cent in the same month last year and by 5 per cent in July this year. The previous low level was recorded in May at 3.2 per cent. The data showed that the production of coal, natural gas, crude oil, and fertiliser dipped in August by 3.8 per cent, 4.9 per cent, 3.6 per cent and 12.4 per cent, respectively.

The growth rate in the output of refinery products, steel and iron ore slowed down to 2.6 per cent, 3.4 per cent and 5.5 per cent, during the month under review as against 3.4 per cent, 15.3 per cent and 7.9 per cent, respectively, in August 2025.

However, cement and electricity production grew by 12.5 per cent and 11.6 per cent, respectively, in August this year. During April-August, the pace of growth was higher at 4.3



**IN APRIL-AUGUST FY27, THE PACE OF GROWTH WAS HIGHER AT 4.3% AGAINST 2.4% IN APRIL-AUG FY26**

per cent compared to 2.4 per cent in the same period of FY26.

Commenting on the numbers, Rahul Agrawal, Principal Economist, ICRA Ltd, said the year-on-year growth in core output eased marginally in August partly on account of an unfavourable base. The deceleration was broad based, with six of the nine sectors reporting a deterioration in their per-

formance between these months, he said, adding that among the mining-related segments, coal and iron ore saw a material deterioration in their performance in August relative to July, largely owing to an adverse base.

Fertiliser output contracted for the sixth consecutive month in August, following the onset of the West Asia crisis, with the growth pace of the sector widening to double digits in the month, Agrawal said. “Given these trends, we expect the IIP growth to ease to about 5-6 per cent in August 2026 from 6.7 per cent in July 2026,” he added.

## Rupee rises 18 paise to 95.78 against US dollar

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Mumbai, September 21

The rupee appreciated 18 paise to close at 95.78 against the US dollar on Monday as crude oil prices retreated from their elevated levels on improved global risk sentiment amid expectations of diplomatic talks between the US & Iran.

Forex traders said the Indian rupee firmed on weak crude oil prices amid hopes of diplomatic talks between the US and Iran. Moreover, positive domestic markets and softening of US Treasury yields also supported the local unit.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.86 against the US dollar, then gained some ground and touched 95.72 against the American currency in intraday trade.

At the end of the trading session on Monday, the rupee settled at 95.78 against the American currency, higher by 18 paise from its previous close.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback’s strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 100.32, higher by 0.10 per cent.

Meanwhile, India’s forex reserves dropped by \$4.924 billion to \$780.782 billion during the week ended September 11 due to a fall in foreign currency and gold reserves, as per the RBI data released on Friday.

## Centre taking measures to build harmonised data infra: MoSPI Secy

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 21

The government is taking steps to build a harmonised data infrastructure to ensure that information can be systematically discovered, understood, connected and utilised, MoSPI Secretary Saurabh Garg said on Monday. Garg was addressing a session at AIMA’s 53rd National Management Convention here.

A harmonised data infrastructure is extremely necessary to ensure that data can be systematically discovered, understood, connected and utilised, said

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
Mumbai, September 21

Banks will not be allowed to reclassify instruments between trading book and banking book for regulatory arbitrage with the intention of achieving lower capital requirements, according to the RBI’s directions on minimum capital requirements for market risk.

The directions, issued on Monday, aim to align the market risk guidelines with the revised Basel III framework, while ensuring simplicity of regulations, and providing flexibility, and ease of adoption.

The directions are applicable to all commercial

banks, except small finance banks, payments banks and local area banks.

RBI said the directions will take effect from April 1, 2027, ensuring sufficient lead time for banks.

“A bank shall not reclassify instruments between the trading book and the banking book for regulatory arbitrage, i.e., with the intention of achieving lower capital requirements,” the central bank said.

It further said that banks will have to use the simplified standardised approach (SSA) for computing risk-weighted assets for market risk.

The risk-weighted assets will be determined by mul-

tipling the capital requirements calculated under the framework by a factor of 12.5.

RBI also said the specific risk tables for interest rate risk have been revised to align with the Basel Committee on Banking Supervision (BCBS) guidelines, which also provide a more concise and clean treatment.

On debt mutual funds/exchange traded funds (ETF) held in the trading book, it said the capital treatment has been revised to ensure capital computation is based on the underlying risk drivers while ensuring sufficient guardrails.

## C Raja Mohan appointed as Director & Professor of Motwani Jadeja Institute for American Studies

MPOST BUREAU  
Sonipat, September 21

O.P. Jindal Global University (JGU) has appointed foreign policy scholar & strategic affairs expert Professor (Dr.) C Raja Mohan as Director & Professor of the Motwani Jadeja Institute for American Studies (MJIAS).

Raja Mohan, who has held senior positions at Carnegie India, the National University of Singapore, JNU & the Library of Congress, will work with Professor (Dr.) Mohan Kumar, Director General of MJIAS,

Dean, Office of the Vice Chancellor, JGU, and former Ambassador of India to France, and Professor (Dr.) C Raj Kumar, Founding Vice Chancellor of JGU and President of MJIAS.

Raja Mohan said, “The India-US relationship is undergoing a profound transformation amid new challenges & possibilities... There is a need for deeper bilateral conversations on trade, energy, defence, science, technology, innovation and education.”

Asha Jadeja Motwani, Chairperson of the Board

and benefactor of MJIAS, said, “Professor Raja Mohan brings an extraordinary combination of scholarship, strategic insight, intellectual independence and profound understanding of India and the US.”

Dr. Shashi Tharoor, Member of Parliament, Chairperson of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on External Affairs and Co-Chairperson of the Board of MJIAS, said, “I warmly welcome Professor C. Raja Mohan’s appointment. He is one of India’s most respected thinkers on

foreign policy, geopolitics and India-U.S. relations.”

Professor (Dr.) C. Raj Kumar, said, “His appointment marks a defining moment for MJIAS,” while Professor (Dr.) Mohan Kumar, said, “His scholarship, experience and understanding of India-US relations will greatly strengthen MJIAS.”

The institute will focus on original research in defence, technology and energy, besides fellowships, The America Roundtable & the Motwani India-US Dialogue.

## Govt dissolves 37-year-old Digital Communications Commission

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
New Delhi, September 21

The government has notified the dissolution of the Digital Communications Commission (DCC), an apex inter-departmental decision-making body at the Department of Telecom formed around 37 years ago to decide on policy matters and subjects with significant financial implications.

Formed in 1989 as the Telecom Commission, it was renamed as the Digital Communications Commission in 2018. “...the Govern-

ment of India has decided that the DCC be dissolved. Now, therefore, with effect from the date of publication of this resolution, the Digital Communications Commission shall stand dissolved,” a notification dated September 19 said.

The apex decision-making body comprising senior officials from NITI Aayog, the Finance Ministry, the Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion and other departments helped resolve contentious issues. The Commission firmed up decisions on the majority

cent, while SmallCap Select index dipped 0.05 per cent.

Among the BSE sectoral indices, Realty jumped 1.71 per cent, Consumer Durables 1.55 per cent, Healthcare 1.12 per cent, FMCG 1.07 per cent, Housing Finance 0.80 per cent and Top 10 Banks 0.71 per cent.

Utilities, Auto, Insurance, Power, MidSmall Private Banks Quality Tilt and MidSmall Private Banks were the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, tanked 2.36 per cent to \$101.4 per barrel.

FIIs bought equities worth Rs 599.54 crore on Friday, according to exchange data.

of telecom matters before they were sent to the Cabinet for final approval.

The Commission helped in taking decisions on matters like spectrum price and recommendations by the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI).

The body held its last meeting on September 3, where it firmed up the decision on satcom spectrum.

The DCC has approved the majority of suggestions given by the TRAI. Its recommendation on satcom spectrum now has to be approved by the cabinet.

## NHAI issues guidelines for high-speed NHs

Guidelines will cover all upcoming 4/6 lane Greenfield, Brownfield National Highways

AGENCIES  
New Delhi, September 21

State-owned NHAI on Monday released comprehensive norms for design and development of access-controlled high-speed National Highways, standardising lane configurations based on detailed traffic assessment to facilitate seamless movement.

The norms seek to bring uniformity in preparation of Detailed Project Reports (DPRs), ensure consistency in technical standards, strengthen

CLOSER LOOK

» The norms seek to bring uniformity in preparation of DPRs, ensure consistency in technical standards, boost road safety

» The framework aligns with the govt’s long-term roadmap to develop 50,000 km of access-controlled High-Speed Corridors

road safety and improve operational efficiency across the National Highway network, an official statement said.

They will apply to all upcoming 4/6-lane Greenfield and Brownfield high-speed access-controlled National Highways. NHAI

said the framework aligns with the government’s long-term roadmap to develop 50,000 km of access-controlled High-Speed Corridors under Viksit Bharat 2047, boosting connectivity and reducing logistics costs.

At present, separate standards for planning and designing access-controlled High-Speed National Highways, other than Expressways, are not available, resulting in variations in DPR standards.

Under the framework, corridors carrying up to 15,000 vehicles will have a four-lane highway and four-lane structures with a 60-metre width. Corridors with traffic flow of 15,000-25,000 vehicles will have a four-lane highway and six-lane structures with a 70-metre

width. Highways carrying 25,000-40,000 vehicles will have six-lane highways and structures with a 70-metre width.

Interchanges will be provided at crossings with Expressways, National Highways, State Highways and major arterial roads, as well as roads connecting ports, airports, MMLPs, industrial areas and major tourist destinations. A 1-metre-high boundary wall will also be built to prevent unauthorised access and stray cattle entry.



**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
**TENDER NOTICE**  
(Through e-tendering)

|                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Name of work with its location                                                                   | Provision of Automatic Media changeover redundant to data transmission on Quad/OFC for UFSBI system over Delhi Division.                                                                         |
| App. Cost of the work (₹)                                                                        | Rs. 3,53,25,057.04/-                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Bid Security (₹)                                                                                 | Rs. 7,06,500.00/-                                                                                                                                                                                |
| Address of the office                                                                            | Senior Divisional Signal & Telecom Engineer-C, Northern Railway, 3 <sup>rd</sup> Floor, Annex-1, DRM Office, New Delhi-110055.                                                                   |
| Date & Time for uploading the tender/closing of the tender                                       | Tender uploading <b>21.09.2026</b> / closing date & time <b>13.10.2026</b> up to 15.00 hrs.                                                                                                      |
| Website particular & notice board location where complete details of the tender can be seen etc. | See the Northern Railway website <a href="http://www.ireps.gov.in">www.ireps.gov.in</a> & Notice board at the S&T branch, 3 <sup>rd</sup> Floor, DRM office, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055. |

Tender No. 558-Sig-16-M-TENDER-1482

Dated: 21.09.2026

3270/2026

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that Sandeep Kumar A Upadhyay/ Shilpi Upadhyay (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBDEL00002275165 located at Apartment No. B2/1704, 17th Floor, JKG Palm Court, Plot No. GH/1-D, Sector 16C, Greater Noida West, UP. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement. The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated August 31, 2026, informing that JKG Construction Pvt. Ltd. has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 22, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited  
Place : Delhi/NCR Sd-

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**  
**E-TENDER NOTICE**

Tender Notice No.: 8120262027

Dated: 19.09.2026

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering)/North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites the following E-Tender on prescribed form for the following works up to 13:30 hrs. on **13.10.2026**. The details of the tenders are as under:-

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>SN. 1.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Tender No.:</b> 172              |
| <b>Name of work:</b> (A) Kanpur Central- Renewal of 150m boundary wall, barbed wire fencing and development of dustbin pocket at NCC under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB. (B) Infrastructure for storage and garage for trucks and other vehicles required at NCC/CNB under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB. (C) Extension of NCC CNB sick line shed by 30m towards DLI and along with one examination pit of one Vande Bharat coach length under ADEN/HQ/II/CNB. |                                     |
| <b>Approx. Cost of Work:</b> ₹ 3,22,79,158.10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Earnest Money:</b> ₹ 6,45,600.00 |
| <b>Completion Period:</b> 12 Months                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Date of Opening:</b> 13.10.2026  |
| <b>Similar work for Eligibility Criteria:</b> Any structural steel fabrication work.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                     |
| <b>SN. 2.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Tender No.:</b> 173              |
| <b>Name of work:</b> Improvement of level crossing no. 1 (CPA) & 82 by rubberized level crossing in CNB-RURA under ADEN/L/CNB.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                     |
| <b>Approx. Cost of Work:</b> ₹ 85,02,247.20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Earnest Money:</b> ₹ 1,70,100.00 |
| <b>Completion Period:</b> 08 Months                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Date of Opening:</b> 13.10.2026  |
| <b>Similar work for Eligibility Criteria:</b> Any work involving supply and fixing of rubberized surface on Roads or Railway level crossing.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                     |
| <b>SN. 3.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Tender No.:</b> 174              |
| <b>Name of work:</b> Flush Butt (FB) welding of rail on various loop lines and other lines in the jurisdiction of ADEN/L/CNB under DEN/V/PRY.J.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                     |
| <b>Approx. Cost of Work:</b> ₹ 3,41,65,869.80                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | <b>Earnest Money:</b> ₹ 6,83,300.00 |
| <b>Completion Period:</b> 12 Months                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Date of Opening:</b> 13.10.2026  |
| <b>Similar work for Eligibility Criteria:</b> Any P.Way work involving weld renewal work with mobile flash butt welding plant.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                     |
| <b>Note:-</b> 1. Tender online can be submitted up to 13:30 hrs. on 13.10.2026. 2. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tenders are available on Website <a href="http://www.ireps.gov.in">www.ireps.gov.in</a> up to 13:30 hrs. on the due date of tender opening i.e. 13.10.2026. 2146/26 (PH)                                                                                                        |                                     |
| <b>f North central railways    @CPRONCR    www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                     |

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that Aditya Prakash/ Prem Shashank (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBGHZ00002441728 located at Flat No 1408, 14th Floor Tower-A2, JKG Palm Court, Situated At Plot No GH-1D Sector-16C, Greater Noida- 201307. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement. The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated August 31, 2026, informing that JKG Construction Pvt. Ltd. has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 22, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited  
Place : Delhi/NCR Sd-

**NORTHERN RAILWAY**  
**TENDER NOTICE**

Tender No.: 2581054TSDSSB

Dated: 16.09.2026

Sr. Divisional Mechanical Engineer, Northern Railway, Trainset Depot, Shakurbasti; for and on behalf of the President of India, invites IREPS ([www.ireps.gov.in](http://www.ireps.gov.in)) for the under noted work.

|                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tender No.</b>                                                                       | <b>2581054TSDSSB</b>                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Name of work</b>                                                                     | Provision for supply and replacement of various types of glass arrangement installed in Vande Bharat Express rakes at Trainset Depot Shakurbasti for a period of two years. |
| <b>Approximate cost</b>                                                                 | ₹ 7,45,83,094.70/- including GST                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Earnest money</b>                                                                    | ₹ 14,91,700.00/-                                                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Completion period of the work</b>                                                    | 24 Months                                                                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Date and time for opening of tender</b>                                              | 08.10.2026 at 14.00.                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen</b> | Above tender is available on IREPS site i.e. <a href="http://www.ireps.gov.in">www.ireps.gov.in</a> w.e.f. 16.09.2026, 16:37 hrs.                                           |
| <b>No.: 25.8.1054.TSD.SSB</b>                                                           | <b>Date: 16.09.2026</b>                                                                                                                                                     |

**SERVING CUSTOMER WITH A SMILE**      3258/2026

**कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियंता,**  
**लोक निर्माण विभाग, विलासपुर मंडल, विलासपुर**  
**ई-प्रोक्वोरमेंट निविदा सूचना**  
**Portal : <http://proc.cgstate.gov.in>**

छत्तीसगढ़ शासन, लोक निर्माण विभाग, विलासपुर मण्डल, विलासपुर में निम्नलिखित कार्य नवीन ई-पंजीयन में पंजीकृत ठेकेदार हेतु सरल क्रं. 01 से 09 हेतु दिनांक 28.09.2026 एवं सरल क्रं. 10 से 17 हेतु दिनांक 08.10.2026 तक, निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

| क्र. | नि.आ. सू. क्र. | कार्य का नाम                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | लागत (लाख में) |
|------|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 1    | 296            | उपरिभाग सारंगढ़ अंतर्गत विभिन्न मार्गों में मरम्मत का कार्य।<br><b>पंचम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 24-3054-0134</b>                                                                                                                                                                           | <b>25.00</b>   |
| 2    | 297            | घरमजरागढ़ उस्मांग के अंतर्गत राज्य मार्ग, जिला मार्ग एवं ग्रामीण विभिन्न मार्गों में डब्ल्यू.एम.ए. एवं बी.टी. पेव मरम्मत कार्य।<br><b>पंचम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 24-3054-7983</b>                                                                                                        | <b>24.86</b>   |
| 3    | 298            | सारंगढ़ उस्मांग के अंतर्गत राज्य मार्ग, जिला मार्ग एवं ग्रामीण विभिन्न मार्गों में डब्ल्यू.एम.ए. एवं बी.टी. पेव मरम्मत कार्य।<br><b>पंचम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 24-3054-0134</b>                                                                                                          | <b>50.00</b>   |
| 4    | 299            | खरसिया उस्मांग के अंतर्गत राज्य मार्ग, जिला मार्ग एवं ग्रामीण विभिन्न मार्गों में डब्ल्यू.एम.ए. एवं बी.टी. पेव मरम्मत कार्य।<br><b>पंचम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 24-3054-7983</b>                                                                                                           | <b>24.94</b>   |
| 5    | 300            | Strengthening and Renewal work of Janjgir Bypass (ODR) Road From Km. 1/2 to 2/4 (100M) = 1.30 Km<br><b>चतुर्थ आमंत्रण। संभाग चांपा। मद संख्या-8443 Deposit Work</b>                                                                                                                                            | <b>77.26</b>   |
| 6    | 301            | B.T. Renewal Work of (1) Arjuni to Karumahu Road (V.R.) Length = 2.00 K.m. (2) Akaltara to Jarve (Khond) Road (V.R.) Length = 1.00 K.m. & (3) Strengthening of Banari App. Road (V.R.) Length = 0.70 km, Under Sub Division Janjgir-Champa.<br><b>चतुर्थ आमंत्रण। संभाग चांपा। मद संख्या-8443 Deposit Work</b> | <b>74.21</b>   |
| 7    | 302            | B.T. Renewal Work of Tarod Kirari-Dharsivra Road (M.D.R.) Length = 1.00 K.m & Upgradation Work of N.I.I.-49 to Arjuni App. Road (V.R.) Length 1.00 K.M. Under Sub - Division Janjgir Distt- Janjgir-Champa<br><b>चतुर्थ आमंत्रण। संभाग चांपा। मद संख्या-8443 Deposit Work</b>                                  | <b>71.90</b>   |
| 8    | 303            | जिला सारंगढ़ के छुछीपली से राजघाट मार्ग लंबाई 2.50 किमी. निर्माण कार्य।<br><b>चतुर्थ आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 24-5054-1222</b>                                                                                                                                                              | <b>179.91</b>  |
| 9    | 304            | जिला सारंगढ़ के शियारपाली फुडूच मार्ग लंबाई 1.20 किमी निर्माण कार्य।<br><b>चतुर्थ आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 24-5054-1222</b>                                                                                                                                                                 | <b>119.04</b>  |
| 10   | 305            | जिला उपमोक्त विवाद प्रतिष्ठान आयोग विलासपुर के प्रवेश द्वार में सिमालिक बोर्ड, बेनेल गेट, कार्यालय भवन में मरम्मत एवं अन्य कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। संभाग क्रं.1 विलासपुर। मद संख्या – 8443 जमा मद</b>                                                                                                      | <b>14.93</b>   |
| 11   | 306            | जिला गोरिला पेण्ड्रा मरावाडी के पेण्ड्रा पतंगवा मार्ग लंबाई 1.20 किमी. निर्माण कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। संभाग पेण्ड्रा। मद संख्या – 42-5054-2450</b>                                                                                                                                                        | <b>144.07</b>  |
| 12   | 307            | सारंगढ़ संभाग के अंतर्गत सामान्य प्रशासन तकनीकी शिक्षा, उच्च शिक्षा, स्कूल शिक्षा, शिक्रिसा महाविद्यालय के रंगाई पोताई का कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 67-2216-4489</b>                                                                                                      | <b>70.00</b>   |
| 13   | 308            | सारंगढ़ संभाग के अंतर्गत लोक निर्माण विभाग के आवासीय एवं गैर आवासीय भवनों का रंगाई पोताई का कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 67-2216-6220</b>                                                                                                                                    | <b>20.00</b>   |
| 14   | 309            | सारंगढ़ संभाग के अंतर्गत न्याय विभाग के आवासीय एवं गैर आवासीय भवनों का रंगाई पोताई का कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 67-2216-2450</b>                                                                                                                                          | <b>80.00</b>   |
| 15   | 310            | घरमजरागढ़ उपसंभाग के अंतर्गत लोक निर्माण विभाग, न्याय विभाग, सामान्य प्रशासन विभाग एवं अन्य विभागों के आवासीय एवं गैर आवासीय भवनों का रंगाई पोताई का कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 67-2216-6220</b>                                                                           | <b>25.00</b>   |
| 16   | 311            | खरसिया उपसंभाग के अंतर्गत लोक निर्माण विभाग, न्याय विभाग, सामान्य प्रशासन विभाग एवं अन्य विभागों के आवासीय एवं गैर आवासीय भवनों का रंगाई पोताई का कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 67-2216-6220</b>                                                                              | <b>25.00</b>   |
| 17   | 312            | सारंगढ़ उपसंभाग के अंतर्गत सामान्य प्रशासन विभाग के आवासीय एवं गैर आवासीय भवनों का रंगाई पोताई का कार्य।<br><b>प्रथम आमंत्रण। सारंगढ़ संभाग सारंगढ़। मद संख्या – 67-2216-4489</b>                                                                                                                              | <b>80.00</b>   |

निविदा में भाग लेने की प्रक्रिया एवं निविदा के संबंध में विस्तृत जानकारी विभाग के उपरोक्त वेबसाईट में देखें जा सकते हैं।

अधीक्षण अभियंता

G 262703386/6

लो.नि.वि.विलासपुर मण्डल, विलासपुर

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

**PUBLIC NOTICE**

The following borrower(s) has/have defaulted in the repayment of principal and interest towards the Loan facility(ies) availed from ICICI Bank. The Loan(s) has/have been classified as Non-Performing Asset(s) (NPA). A Notice was issued to them under Section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002, at their last known addresses. However, it has not been served and are therefore being notified by way of this Public Notice.

| Sr. No. | Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Guarantor/ (Loan Account Number & Address                                                                                              | Description of Secured Asset to be enforced                                                                                                                                                             | Date of Notice sent/ Outstanding as on Date of Notice | NPA Date    |
|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| 1.      | Ankur Bedi/ Sudesh Bedi/ LBDEL00005327887/ House No. B7 Pandara Road Near India Gate, Lodhi Road Central Delhi, New Delhi- 110003                                         | Flat No. J-1401, 14th Floor, Tower-J, "The Golden Poles", Situated At Plot No. GH-01/E, Sector-168, (Along With 1 Covered Car Parking Space) Noida, District- Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201301 | 05/09/2026<br>Rs. 22,25,401.6/-                       | 09-Jul-2026 |
| 2.      | Pratima Walde/ Manoj Kumar Meshram/ LBND000002114321/ H No. G-16 Nivedit Shakara Charyakalanji BHU-PS Lanka, Varanasi, Uttar Pradesh Varanasi- 221001                     | Flat No. T5-801, 8th Floor, Tower 5, Block-A, "sunibera Towers" Situated At Plot No. GH-16F, Sector-1, Greater Noida (West) Uttar Pradesh- 201307                                                       | 03/09/2026<br>Rs. 28,49,983.2/-                       | 09-Jul-2026 |
| 3.      | Ankita Agarwal/ Investright Property Consultants Llp/ Amit Agarwal/ LBFDB000002859815/ Arun 1702 Paramount, Floraville, Sec-137, Bareilly, Uttar Pradesh Bareilly- 201304 | Unit No. 1702, 17th Floor, Block-Arum, Paramount Floraville, Situated At GH-06, Sector-137, Expressway, Noida Gautam Buddha Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201301 (Along With One Covered Car Parking Space)      | 03/09/2026<br>Rs. 10,79,438.95/-                      | 04-Jul-2026 |
| 4.      | Dinesh Kalra (Deceased- Through His Legal Heirs)/ Preeti Kalra/ LBDEL00001530345/ 952 Arjun Nagar Kotla Mubarak Pur, Delhi- 110003                                        | Flat No. 1102, 11th Floor, Block No. 16, Unitech Horizon, Situated At Plot No. 06, Sec- Pl- II (Alisonia Estate) Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh- 201306                                                    | 02/09/2026<br>Rs. 86,55,275/-                         | 31-Aug-2019 |
| 5.      | Abhishek Dwivedi/ Arun Kumar Dwivedi/ LBGUR00002822932/ Village Barola, Near Kiran Hospital Floor Sec 49, Balrampur Noida Uttar Pradesh- 201301                           | Flat No. Detroit- 12A- 01, 12th A Floor, "Oasis Grand Stand" Situated At GH-01, TS 01 B, Sector-22 D, Yamuna Expressway, Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201303                                        | 29/08/2026<br>Rs. 21,46,209/-                         | 08-Jun-2026 |
| 6.      | Kamini Bhatia/ Puneet, Bhatia/ LBGHZ00005301490/ Flat No. 701 Tower A Royal Park, Sector 7 Vaishali le Sahibabad Uttar Pradesh Ghaziabad- 200001                          | Apartment No. 2552, 24th Floor, Tower-F, "gaur Siddhartham", Situated At Plot No. 08/BS-01, Siddharth Vihar Vojana, Sector-8, Pargana Loni, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh- 201001                            | 22/08/2026<br>Rs. 27,77,804.48/-                      | 29-Jun-2026 |
| 7.      | Kuldeep Chand/ Saruchi/ LBND000003850673/ Flat No. 191 SF, Block C1 Sector- 55, Gautam Buddha Nagar Noida- 201301                                                         | EVWS Flat No. 191, 2nd Floor, Block C1, Sector 55, Noida District Gautam Budh Nagar Uttar Pradesh- 201301                                                                                               | 22/08/2026<br>Rs. 17,13,733/-                         | 03-Jun-2026 |
| 8.      | Sita Ram Gupta/ Mira Devi/ LBND00003104204/ C6 171 Sec 31 Uttar Pradesh Noida- 201301                                                                                     | Flat No. I-504, 5th Floor, Block- I, Aims Green Avenue Situated At Plot No. GH-04, Setor-04, Greater Noida West- 201308                                                                                 | 22/08/2026<br>Rs. 16,20,792/-                         | 30-Jun-2026 |

These steps are being taken for substituted service of Notice. The above borrower/s and/or guarantor/s (as applicable) is/are advised to make the outstanding payment within 60 days from the date of publishing this Notice. Else, further steps will be taken as per the provisions of the Securitisation and Re-construction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Date: September 22, 2026  
Place: Delhi/ Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,  
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

**SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE**

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice. Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

| Sr. No. | Name of the Borrower/s/ Loan Account Number    | Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession                                                                                                                   | Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs) | Name of Branch |
|---------|------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| 1.      | Amit Singla/ Khushboo Kumari/ TBNOD00006627097 | Residential House No 55, Block-D, Sector- Beta-01, Allotment No. B019591, Situated In Greater Noida District Gautam Budh Nagar, Noida U.P.- 201307/ September 18, 2026 | May 26, 2026<br>Rs. 48,21,582.27/-                  | Delhi NCR      |

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/guarantors(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: September 22, 2026  
Place: Delhi/Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,  
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**(See Section 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rahul** S/o Sh. Ram Kishan R/o H. No. 30/8-A, Hari Om Gali, Babarpur, North East, New Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 407/2018 U/s 454/380/511/34 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rahul** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rahul** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rahul** in **FIR No. 407/2018 U/s 454/380/511/34 IPC, PS Tilak Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.11.2026**.

By order  
**Sh. Vikas Madaan**  
Judicial Magistrate First Class  
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/13345/WD/2026

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**See Section 82 CrPc**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Sunil Kumar R/o N-22, B-389, Kaushal Puri, Near Railway Line, Azadpur, Delhi-110033, Mob. No. 9650449582** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **CC NI ACT 374/2021 U/S 138 NI ACT, PS Model Town, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Sunil Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sunil Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunil Kumar of CC NI ACT 374/2021 U/S 138 NI ACT, PS Model Town, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **30.10.2026**.

By Order,  
**Sh. Gaurav Dahiyaa**  
Judicial Magistrate First Class(NI Act)  
Room No. 118, First Floor, North District  
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13226/NW/2026(Court Matter)

Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No.23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi-110005

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
Builder Cancellation

This is to bring to your notice that NEERA SHARMA / ANKUR MOHAN (borrower/s) has availed Home loan facility vide facility agreement number LBGUR00002313398 located at B2-1304, 13TH FLOOR, JKG PALM COURT, PLOT NO. GH-1D, SECTOR 16C, GREATER NOIDA WEST, UP. The borrower/s has failed to pay the contractual amount to the builder as per the terms and conditions of the agreement. The Bank had informed the same to the borrower through letter dated Aug 31, 2026, informing that JKG CONSTRUCTION PVT. LTD. has cancelled the allotment of the above mentioned property. You are therefore requested to resolve this matter with the builder within 7 days from the date of this publication.

Please take further notice that post cancellation of the allotment of the said property ICICI Bank shall not be bound and/or responsible for any other allotment done by the builder.

Dated: September 22, 2026 For ICICI Bank Limited  
Place : Delhi/NCR Sd-

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**See Section 82 CrPc**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Roshana Begum W/o Late Babu Khan R/o Kh. No.-758, H.No. A-2/40-41, A-Block, Gali No.-6 Near Madina Dhabha, Rajiv Nagar, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi & Old Add.:- D-709, Jahangirpuri, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 457/2023, PS Jahangirpuri, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Roshana Begum** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Roshana Begum** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Roshana Begum** the said accused of **FIR No. 457/2023, PS Jahangirpuri, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **22.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Sh. Kuljeevan Sidharth**  
Addtl. Sessions Judge (Electricity),  
North-West Distt., Court No. 316,  
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13318/NW/2026  
(Court Matter)

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**See Section 82 Cr.P.C.**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Robin @ Gajender, S/o: Babu Lal, R/o: H.No. B-716, Aman Vihar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 69/2015, U/s 354A/341/509 IPC, P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Robin @ Gajender** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Robin @ Gajender** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Robin @ Gajender** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 69/2015, U/s 354A/341/509 IPC, P.S.: Aman Vihar, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Ms. Neha Goel**  
Judicial Magistrate First Class  
(Mahila Court-02), Room No. 18,  
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/13122/RD/2026  
(Court Matter)

**PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON**

**See Section 82 Cr.P.C / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sannhita, 2023**

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Mohd. Sonu, S/o.: Mohd. Sakil, R/o.: Mandi Wali Gali, Shaheen Bagh, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in a case vide **FIR No.0194/2024 Dt.05.03.2024 U/S 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) BNS** registered at **P.S. New Friends Colony, South East District, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued stating that the said accused **Mohd. Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Mohd. Sonu** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mohd. Sonu**, accused of **FIR No. 0194/2024 Dt.05.03.2024 U/S 304(2)/317(2)/3(5) BNS** registered at **P.S. New Friends Colony, South East District, New Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.10.2026**.

By Order  
**Sh. Vinod Joshi**  
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate,  
South East District, Court No. 516,  
Saket Court, New Delhi

DP/ 13300/SE/2026  
(Court Matter)





ACCORDING TO HER, THERE'S STILL A GAP IN HOW THE ENTERTAINMENT BUSINESS CREATES REAL STARDOM

## 'DON'T THINK ACTING WELL IS ENOUGH TO GAIN STARDOM'

'Mirzapur' star Shriya Pilgaonkar got candid on stardom

Despite earning widespread recognition through the hit series 'Mirzapur', Shriya Pilgaonkar believes that OTT fame doesn't guarantee a smooth transition to stardom. In a candid conversation, she opened up about how talent and visibility alone aren't enough to sustain a career; actors also need the right opportunities and industry backing to truly make it big.

As reported in 'Mid-day', when asked what it takes to achieve stardom today, Shriya explained, "The definition of stardom has changed over a period of time because stars were not accessible before; they were aspirational. Today it's more about relatability."

There's still a gap in how the entertainment business creates real stardom, particularly for the newer set of actors who've become familiar faces through streaming rather than

theatrical releases. But according to Pilgaonkar, simply being visible or skilled at acting isn't enough to achieve the kind of stardom that's long been associated with the movies. "In our industry, casting based on merit doesn't happen often. You do need more risk-takers and the audacity to cast. I don't think acting well is enough to gain stardom. You either consciously work towards it with the right machinery and mechanism, or you let it happen organically," she said.

Shriya sees a genuine divide between recognition earned on streaming platforms and the stardom that comes from theatrical success. Even though an actor can establish credibility through OTT work, she thinks the industry still views those who've made their name through commercially successful theatrical films in a different light. "Positioning and mounting play a huge role in the quality of work that comes to an actor. Having commercial success puts [me] in a better position to be seen differently and capable of holding space on the big screen."

She also feels the industry needs to give performers room to evolve past the categories they're first slotted into. "This is an industry that likes to keep artists where they are," she said. AGENCIES



## Kunal confirms 'Madgaon Express 2'

Kemmu revealed that he has already written a story for the sequel

Kunal Kemmu is set to return to the world of 'Madgaon Express'. The actor-filmmaker, whose directorial 'VIBE' is currently in theatres, confirmed that he is developing 'Madgaon Express 2', the sequel to his 2024 directorial debut.

In a recent conversation, Kemmu revealed that he has already written a story for the sequel, although he isn't ready to commit to a timeline or reveal whether the original cast will return. Kemmu told 'Variety India' that he had previously made it clear that he would not return to the franchise without a story that genuinely warranted a sequel.

"I've always said that I will not make 'Madgaon Express 2' unless I genuinely feel that there is a story to tell. Luckily, the collaborators and producers also didn't bother me after that. Everyone said, 'Okay, you figure it out'," he said.

While he has stopped short of announcing a timeline, Kemmu confirmed that he has already written a story for the sequel. "I have a story to tell, which I have written. At this point, I'll keep it at that," he revealed.

'Madgaon Express' also changed Kemmu's perspective on filmmaking. AGENCIES

## VIDYA BALAN TO FEATURE IN 'JAILER 2'

**NEW DELHI:** Vidya Balan has joined Tamil superstar Rajinikanth-starrer 'Jailer 2'. The film is the sequel to Rajinikanth's 2023 release 'Jailer'. It is directed by Nelson Dilipkumar, the filmmaker behind the first instalment.

Production banner 'Sun Pictures' shared the announcement with a post on 'Instagram' on Monday, which featured the teaser of the actress. She will essay the role of Kantha in the film.

"Introducing Vidya Balan as Kantha from the world of #Jailer2," read the caption. It featured the actress in a blue sari as she walks down the stairs holding a cigarette. Balan reshared the post on her handle. The film will be released globally on October 15 and will have music composed by Anirudh Ravichander.

'Jailer' emerged as the highest-grossing Tamil film when it was released and featured Rajinikanth as retired jailer Muthuvel Pandian, who leads a quiet life with his family after hanging up his uniform. PTI

SHE WILL ESSAY THE ROLE OF KANTHA IN THE FILM



(1955-2026)

WIT, BEAUTY, SENSUALITY AND SPONTANEITY CAME TOGETHER IN ACTRESS **Mithu Mukherjee's** SHORT BUT MEMORABLE FILMOGRAPHY IN 'MARJINA ABDULLAH', 'MOUCHAK' AND 'SWAYAMSIDDHA'

ANINDITA ACHARYA  
Kolkata, September 21

On Sunday night, at the age of 71, Bengali actress Mithu Mukherjee passed away at a private hospital in Mumbai. She had been battling cancer for a long time. Bengali cinema saw several actresses emerge in the 1970s, but few managed to leave an impression quite like Mithu did. She didn't work in too many films, but the ones she did, like 'Marjina Abdullah', 'Mouchak', 'Swayamsiddha', 'Nishi Kanya', 'Pratima', 'Safed Jhooth' in Hindi and 'Ashrita', her last Bengali film, never quite left the minds of cinegoers.

But Mithu wasn't merely a brilliant, natural actress. Along with her organic acting skills, it was her vivacious screen presence that set her apart from her contemporaries. She possessed a spirited, mischievous and almost teasing personality, something that was brilliantly reflected in her characters in 'Marjina Abdullah', 'Mouchak' and 'Swayamsiddha'. Calling her merely glamorous would be an understatement. She was a complete package of beauty, sensuality, innocence, wit and mischief, with a dash of unpredictability that made her memorable among the leading actresses

## MITHU MUKHERJEE THE BEAUTY OF BEING PLAYFUL



IT WAS MITHU'S VIVACIOUS SCREEN PRESENCE THAT SET HER APART FROM HER CONTEMPORARIES



of her generation.

Born in Kolkata on June 19, 1955, Mithu entered the industry at the age of 17, making her debut with 'Shesh Parba' in 1972. Despite featuring stars such as Pahari Sanyal, Utpal Dutt, Sabitri Chatterjee and Samit Bhanja, the film didn't work. But later that year, 'Marjina Abdullah' came. As Marjina, Mithu not only displayed her strength as a natural actress but also her dancing skills and sensuous screen presence, winning over audiences.

She followed it up with 'Nishi Kanya' alongside Soumitra Chatterjee in 1973. But it was 1974 and 1975 that became the defining years of her career, with Arabinda Mukherjee's iconic 'Mouchak' and 'Swayamsiddha', respectively. Ranjit Mallick was her leading man in both. On Monday, Mallick posted a video message remembering his 'Mouchak' co-star. Yet to come to terms with her demise, the actor spoke of Mithu's stunning act in 'Swayamsiddha' opposite

a legendary actress like Chhaya Devi. "She was younger than us. This kind of news is so shocking. I still can't believe this," he said.

Mithu became so popular with her 'Mouchak' act that it's said Uttam Kumar wanted her as his co-actress. In 1976, the two shared the screen in 'Hotel Snow Fox' and 'Chander Kachhakachi', though neither film worked at the box office.

At the height of her career, Mithu also worked in Hindi films, mostly with veteran filmmaker Basu Chatterjee. In 1977, she made her Hindi film debut with Chatterjee's 'Safed Jhooth', a remake of the Bengali film 'Chhutir Phandey'. The film starred Vinod Mehra and Ashok Kumar. She subsequently acted in 'Dillagi' and 'Do Ladke Dono Kadke', both directed by Chatterjee.

Like Bollywood's iconic actress Rekha, who believed in enhancing her natural features, particularly her deep, expressive eyes and lips, Mithu too had a distinctive physical presence that needed little embellishment. It didn't take long for cinelovers to compare her with Rekha. Many film critics, however, also found shades of Mumtaz in her. Her jest, her dance moves and her pout, they believed, were more reminiscent of Mumtaz. Unlike the prim, proper and petite

image associated with several Bengali actresses of the time, Mithu was raw and uninhibited, many critics believe.

In Bengali cinema, the legendary Suchitra Sen chose to leave the film industry gracefully and lead a private life. Mithu did something similar. After 'Prarthana' in 1984, she took a six-year hiatus before returning with the Bengali film 'Ashrita', directed by 'Don' Chandra Barot. The film became a huge hit. Yet after that, she largely stayed away from the spotlight. She had a house in Kolkata, which she later sold before settling in Mumbai.



## 'Dharma Production' announces film on R&AW founder R N Kao



**NEW DELHI:** After 'Kesari', 'Raazi', 'SherShah' and 'Kesari: Chapter 2', Karan Johar is all set to bring forward the story of another unsung legend to the big screen. Reliable sources confirm that 'Dharma Production' is teaming up with 'Leo Media Collective' for a big-scale theatrical feature film on Rameshwar Nath Kao, the founder of R&AW in 1968.

The yet-untitled film is looking at a theatrical release on August 11, 2028, which coincides with the Indepen-

THE YET-UNTITLED FILM IS LOOKING AT A THEATRICAL RELEASE ON AUGUST 11, 2028

dence Day weekend. The makers announced the film today, September 21, 2026, marking 58 years since the foundation of R&AW, with a theatrical release aimed for 2028 to honour the 60-year legacy of India's external intelligence agency. PTI